

Tabby: An Open Pretraining Recipe for Time Series Foundation Models

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Abstract

In this report, we release TABBY, a long context probabilistic time series foundation model, together with a complete and open recipe of how it was built. TABBY adopts an encoder-only patch Transformer architecture and concentrates the contributions on the data and the training procedure. The pretraining corpus combines an extended real-world collection, GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ and BLAST, with synthetic data from KernelSynth and CauKerV2, an online generator that composes temporal dynamics through randomly sampled structural causal models. Training couples a progressive convergence schedule, which yields reusable intermediate checkpoints, with a deep quantile supervision objective for intermediate layers. The resulting 145M parameter backbone supports contexts of up to 8,192 observations and serves forecasting, classification, and anomaly detection, while a prompt-tuning module further improves in-distribution forecasting performance with the pretrained weights frozen. TABBY achieves competitive zero-shot forecasting performance on GIFT-Eval and the out-of-distribution TIME benchmark, while the same pretrained backbone also supports classification on the UCR Archive and zero-shot anomaly detection on TSB-AD-U. We release training pipeline and model as open source at [huawei-noah/trustworthyAI](https://github.com/huawei-noah/trustworthyAI).

1 Introduction

Time series are widely used in healthcare (Burger et al., 2024), finance (Xie et al., 2026b), transportation (Yanes-Pulido & Rodrigues, 2026), telecommunications (Zanouda et al., 2024), and many other domains (Wang et al., 2026). Despite their different origins, time series often share common temporal patterns, such as trends, seasonality, local dependencies, and abrupt changes (Liu et al., 2026d; Kottapalli et al., 2025). These shared structures make it possible to train time series foundation models (TSFMs) that transfer knowledge across datasets and domains (Xie et al., 2026c; Liang et al., 2024). Recent models such as TimesFM-3 (Das et al., 2024) and Falcon-2 (Xia et al., 2026) achieve strong zero-shot forecasting performance on diverse benchmarks (Shchur et al., 2026; Aksu et al., 2024; Qiao et al., 2026).

However, this progress remains difficult to build on. First, pretraining a TSFM is expensive to reproduce. Assembling a large and diverse corpus requires considerable collection effort, and the training process usually demands substantial computational resources. Second, the process is often partially documented. Detailed but consequential choices, such as dataset balancing, window sampling, masking strategies, normalization, learning-rate scheduling, and checkpoint management, have a major influence on the final model, yet they are often not reported in enough detail to be re-implemented. Recent work has shown that a patch-based Transformer trained on open data with a well-tuned recipe matches specialized architectures (Wen et al.,

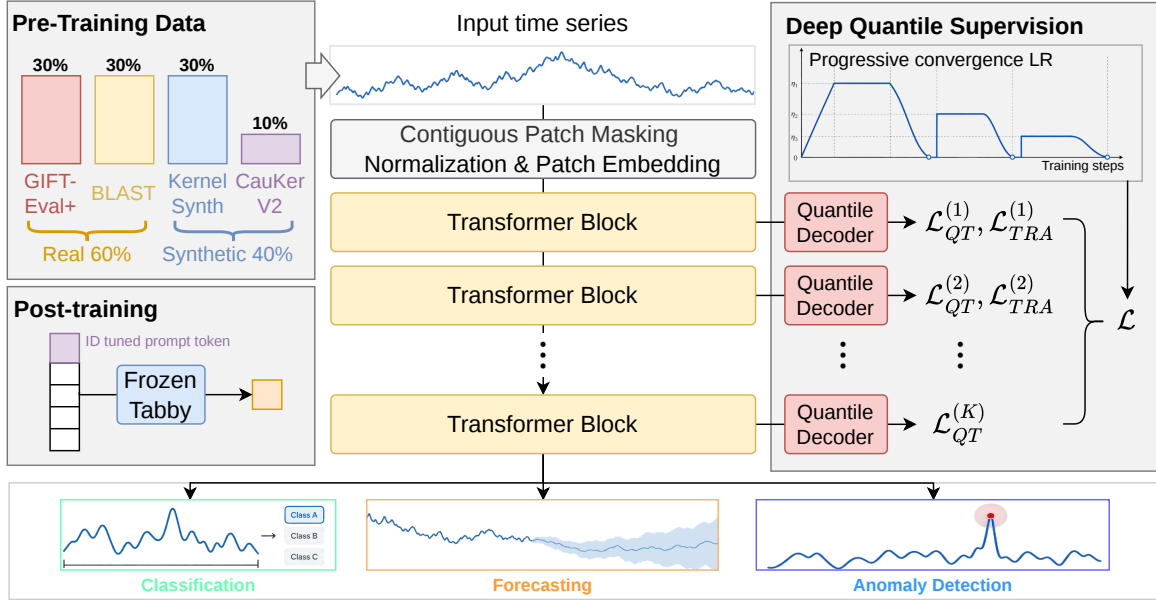


Figure 1: Overview of TABB Y. The model is pretrained on real and synthetic time series using deep quantile supervision and progressive convergence learning rate schedule, and supports forecasting, classification, and anomaly detection.

2026), suggesting that these data and training decisions, rather than architectural differences, are the primary drivers of TSFM performance. Making these decisions explicit is therefore a central aim of this report. In addition, most open recipes target zero-shot forecasting only, while practical deployments also require classification and anomaly detection.

In this report, we propose TABB Y, a long context probabilistic TSFM, together with a complete and open account of how it was built. TABB Y adopts the encoder-only patch Transformer architecture (Nie et al., 2023; Wen et al., 2026), and concentrates the contributions on the two factors identified above: the data and the training procedure. On the data side, we combine a curated and extended real-world corpus (GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ (Aksu et al., 2024) and BLAST (Shao et al., 2025)) with complementary synthetic data from KernelSynth (Ansari et al., 2024) and CauKerV2. CauKerV2 extends CauKer (Xie et al., 2026a) from classification to forecasting, which composes ten families of temporal dynamics through randomly sampled structural causal models and generates data online during pretraining. On the training side, we introduce a progressive convergence learning rate schedule (PCS) that yields reusable, locally converged checkpoints throughout pretraining, and a deep quantile supervision (DQS) objective that supervises intermediate layers along the trajectory between the initial and final predictions. In addition, we equip the backbone with a parameter-efficient prompt-tuning module for in-distribution forecasting adaptation (Xiao et al., 2026), which further improves performance while keeping the pretrained weights frozen. Moreover, a single pre-trained backbone is then extended to three tasks: forecasting, classification, and anomaly detection. The pretrained model has 145.843M parameters, supports contexts of up to 8,192 observations, and outputs quantile forecasts. The pretraining corpus totals 229.80B GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ (Aksu et al., 2024) and 81.92B BLAST (Shao et al., 2025) real-world time points and 48M synthetic samples. An illustration of TABB Y is provided in Figure 1. All components, including the corpus construction recipe, the training pipeline, and the model itself, are released as open source [huawei-noah/trustworthyAI](https://github.com/huawei-noah/trustworthyAI).

On zero-shot forecasting, TABB Y is competitive with recent TSFMs on GIFT-Eval (Aksu et al., 2024) and on the out-of-distribution TIME benchmark (Qiao et al., 2026). Beyond forecasting, the same pretrained backbone supports classification and anomaly detection, evaluated on UCR Dau et al. (2019) and TSB-AD-U (Liu & Paparrizos, 2024).

In summary, our main contributions are:

- **The Tabby model.** We release TABBY, a long context probabilistic TSFM that serves forecasting, classification, and anomaly detection from a single pretrained backbone, with top tier zero-shot forecasting performance on GIFT-Eval (Aksu et al., 2024) and TIME (Qiao et al., 2026).
- **A feasible pretraining corpus.** We construct a large and diverse pretraining corpus that combines curated real-world time series with complementary synthetic data, most notably from CauKerV2, an online generator that extends CauKer (Xie et al., 2026a) from classification to forecasting. We release the data, the generators, and the construction recipe.
- **An open-source pretraining pipeline.** We introduce progressive convergence learning rate schedule that produces reusable intermediate checkpoints, together with deep quantile supervision objective for intermediate layers. The full pipeline, including data processing, balanced sampling, distributed training, and evaluation, is released for end-to-end reproduction.

2 Related Work

Time series forecasting has largely relied on task-specific models trained separately for individual datasets or application domains (Kim et al., 2025). Global forecasting models, such as DeepAR (Salinas et al., 2019), represented an important step toward sharing statistical information across related series, while architectures such as PatchTST (Nie et al., 2023) introduced patch-based representations and channel-independent modeling for efficient forecasting. Nevertheless, these models were primarily developed under dataset-specific training or downstream adaptation settings (Zeng et al., 2022). The emergence of time series foundation models has shifted this paradigm toward large scale pretraining followed by zero-shot forecasting on previously unseen datasets. Representative models, including TimeGPT (Garza et al., 2024), Lag-Llama (Rasul et al., 2024), TimesFM (Das et al., 2024), Chronos Ansari et al. (2024), and Moirai (Woo et al., 2024), employ different architectures and prediction objectives but share the goal of learning transferable temporal patterns from large and heterogeneous time series corpora.

More recent TSFMs have extended this paradigm along several dimensions. Models such as Tirez (Auer et al., 2025), Sundial (Liu et al., 2026b), and PatchTST-FM (Wen et al., 2026) support probabilistic forecasting through discrete sampling, parametric distributions, generative objectives, or direct quantile prediction. Moirai-2 (Liu et al., 2026a) and Chronos-2 (Ansari et al., 2025) extend zero-shot forecasting to multivariate series and covariate-informed settings, while TiRex-2 (Podest et al., 2026) further supports long-context and streaming inference. At the frontier of model scaling, Timer-S1 (Liu et al., 2026c) further pushes TSFMs into the billions parameter through a sparse mixture-of-experts architecture. Synthetic data have also become an important component of TSFM pretraining: ForecastPFN (Dooley et al., 2023) is trained entirely on synthetic series (Xie et al., 2026a; Oreshkin et al., 2026), whereas toto-2 (Cohen et al., 2024; Khwaja et al., 2026) combine real-world data with synthetic processes designed to increase temporal and cross-variable diversity. To the best of our knowledge, PatchTST-FM (Wen et al., 2026) is the model most closely related to TABBY, as both adopt a channel independent patch Transformer, masked reconstruction, long input contexts, and dense quantile prediction. TABBY further introduces CauKerV2 as a structurally diverse synthetic data generator, progressive convergence learning rate schedule, and deep supervision across intermediate transformer layers. In addition, we release the complete end-to-end pretraining codebase, covering data construction, synthetic data generation, distributed training, checkpoint continuation, and evaluation.

3 Preliminary

Univariate TSFM Task Formulation Let $\mathbf{x}_{1:T} = (x_1, \dots, x_T) \in \mathbb{R}^T$ denote a univariate time series observed over a context window of length T . Given a forecasting horizon H , the objective is to predict the future sequence $\mathbf{y}_{1:H} = (x_{T+1}, \dots, x_{T+H}) \in \mathbb{R}^H$. A forecasting model $f_\theta(\cdot)$ parameterized by θ therefore learns the mapping $\hat{\mathbf{y}}_{1:H} = f_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{1:T})$. In probabilistic forecasting, the model estimates a predictive distribution for each future value rather than producing only a single point estimate. Beyond forecasting, we also consider time series classification and anomaly detection. Given an input series $\mathbf{x}_{1:T}$, classification aims to predict a sequence-level label $y \in \{1, \dots, C\}$. Anomaly detection instead assigns each time step an anomaly

score $a_t \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$, where a larger value indicates a stronger deviation from the temporal patterns learned by the model.

Quantile Forecasting Objective To represent predictive uncertainty, the model estimates conditional quantiles for a predefined set $\mathcal{Q} \subset (0, 1)$. For each horizon step h and quantile level $\tau \in \mathcal{Q}$, it predicts $\hat{q}_{h,\tau}$ as an approximation of $q_\tau(y_h \mid \mathbf{x}_{1:T}) = \inf\{z : \Pr(y_h \leq z \mid \mathbf{x}_{1:T}) \geq \tau\}$. The model is trained using the pinball loss $\rho_\tau(u) = u(\tau - \mathbb{I}[u < 0])$, where $\mathbb{I}[\cdot]$ denotes the indicator function, giving the forecasting objective

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{QT}} = \frac{1}{H|\mathcal{Q}|} \sum_{h=1}^H \sum_{\tau \in \mathcal{Q}} \rho_\tau(y_h - \hat{q}_{h,\tau}).$$

Minimizing this objective enables the model to estimate both the central forecast and the uncertainty of future observations.

4 Tabby Model Architecture

TABBY is an encoder-only, non-autoregressive model that supports forecasting, classification, and anomaly detection. We use forecasting as the pretraining task, and extend the pretrained model to classification and anomaly detection through downstream task tuning (Feofanov et al., 2026).

During pretraining, we formulate forecasting as masked reconstruction within a fixed-length window. The window contains both the observed history and the masked positions to be predicted. After mask-aware reversible normalization (details shown in section 6.1), the normalized values are divided into non-overlapping patches and mapped to token embeddings. Learned positional embeddings are then added, and the resulting tokens are processed by a stack of bidirectional transformer blocks. Since the future values are replaced by masked inputs, the encoder can attend globally without observing the prediction targets.

A shared decoder maps every patch to a set of quantiles for each time point. The quantiles are constructed from cumulative positive increments, which guarantees their monotonic ordering by design. The predictions are finally transformed back to the original scale. For multivariate inputs, the current implementation applies the same model to each channel independently. It therefore shares parameters across channels but does not explicitly model cross-channel interactions. Complete architectural equations and hyperparameters are provided in Appendix A.

5 Pretraining Data

In this section, we present the construction and composition of the pretraining corpus used for TABBY. The corpus integrates complementary real and synthetic time series. The real-world component is primarily built upon GIFT-Eval-Pretrain and BLAST, while the synthetic component consists of KernelSynth and our proposed online CauKerV2 samples. Both the real-world datasets and synthetic data generation pipelines will be made publicly available, supporting transparent and reproducible corpus construction.

5.1 Real-World Time Series Corpora

The real-world component of our pretraining corpus is constructed from two primary open-source datasets: GIFT-Eval-Pretrain (Aksu et al., 2024) and BLAST (Shao et al., 2025).

GIFT-Eval-Pretrain consists of a heterogeneous collection of time series datasets from multiple application domains. However, its constituent datasets vary substantially in size. Directly sampling individual series from their union would cause a small number of extremely large datasets to dominate pretraining. We therefore adopt a sub-dataset-balanced sampling strategy. Let D denote the number of constituent datasets. At each sampling step, we first sample a dataset uniformly and then sample a time series from the selected dataset:

$$d \sim \text{Uniform}(1, \dots, D), \quad x \sim p_d(x),$$

where p_d denotes the empirical distribution of the (d)-th dataset. Consequently, every constituent dataset has an expected sampling probability of $1/D$, independently of its raw number of time series. This strategy prevents very large datasets from overwhelming the pretraining distribution.

Uniform sub-dataset sampling may, however, repeatedly expose the model to examples from extremely small datasets and thereby increase the risk of overfitting. To mitigate this issue, we merge selected small datasets from the same or closely related application domains into larger composite sampling units. This preserves the contribution of relatively small domains while avoiding disproportionate oversampling of individual small datasets.

We further expand the original GIFT-Eval-Pretrain corpus by comparing its dataset inventory with the training corpora used by Chronos and Tires-2. We selectively incorporate complementary, high quality datasets. Importantly, the resulting corpus is not a direct union of the three training corpora: only eligible datasets that satisfy our quality, length, predictability, and benchmark-separation criteria are retained. We refer to the resulting curated and extended corpus as GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+.

Our second major real-world source is BLAST. BLAST is already constructed to provide a strongly balanced distribution of temporal patterns. We therefore stream BLAST records directly during pretraining. Its main limitation is the sequence length, where the available BLAST records contain at most 4,096 time steps.

The two corpora are therefore complementary. BLAST provides extensive and explicitly balanced coverage of temporal patterns, but is restricted to relatively short and fixed-width sequences. GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ offers broader domain heterogeneity and substantially greater length diversity, although its raw constituent datasets are not intrinsically balanced and consequently require an explicit sampling strategy. Detailed dataset-level sources, filtering decisions, and corpus statistics are reported in Appendix B.

5.2 Kernel Generated Synthetic Data

KernelSynth was introduced together with the Chronos family and has since been widely adopted for pre-training of TSFMs. It samples time series from Gaussian processes defined by randomly composed kernels. A major limitation of KernelSynth is its computational cost. Constructing and sampling from a Gaussian-process covariance matrix becomes increasingly expensive as the sequence length grows, with the practical generation cost increasing at least quadratically with the target context length. Moreover, the available generation pipeline is CPU-bound.

To improve efficiency, we generate each sequence on a temporal grid that is four times coarser than the target resolution and subsequently upsample it to the desired context length through interpolation. For a target length T , KernelSynth therefore operates on approximately $T/4$ points. Under quadratic scaling, this reduces the main generation cost by approximately $\frac{(T/4)^2}{T^2} = \frac{1}{16}$, while the interpolation step introduces only linear overhead. Since individual synthetic sequences and output shards can be generated independently, we additionally distribute the generation process across multiple parallel CPU tasks. This combination of coarse-grid generation, interpolation, and task-level parallelism makes large-scale long-context KernelSynth pretraining substantially more practical.

5.3 CauKerV2

Although KernelSynth provides useful smooth and temporal dependent series, its kernel-based construction captures only a limited range of temporal patterns. Moreover, the high computational cost of Gaussian process sampling makes it difficult to generate sufficiently diverse samples online during pretraining. To complement KernelSynth and reduce overfitting to a fixed synthetic corpus, we introduce CauKerV2 as an additional source of pretraining data. CauKerV2 extends CauKer (Xie et al., 2026a) by using a broader collection of primitive time series generators. Rather than relying solely on Gaussian processes, CauKerV2 spans ten families of temporal dynamics commonly observed across diverse domains. Table 1 summarizes the generators used to construct the synthetic time series.

For each synthetic sample, CauKerV2 draws a set of primitive series and combines them through a randomly sampled structural causal model (SCM Pearl (2009); Hollmann et al. (2023); Taga et al. (2025)). Each

Table 1: Primitive generator families used by CauKerV2. The listed application domains are representative rather than exhaustive.

Generator family	Temporal characteristics	Representative domains
Compositional Kernel Gaussian Process	Smoothness and local correlations	Weather, energy, environmental sensing
Trend Seasonality Decomposition	Trends with additive or multiplicative seasonality	Retail, traffic, electricity demand
Autoregressive Integrated Moving Average	Linear dependence, integration, and seasonal autoregression	Economics, demand, climate
Regime-Switching Ornstein–Uhlenbeck Stochastic Differential Equation	Mean reversion, stochastic fluctuations, and regime transitions	Finance, physical systems
Piecewise Level and Change-Point Process	Abrupt or smooth level shifts and piecewise-stationary behavior	Industrial monitoring, operations
Spike and Event Process	Spikes, bursts, shocks, plateaus, and recovery patterns	Web traffic, energy, healthcare
Analytic Waveform Mixture	Sawtooth, square, and triangular periodic signals	Sensors, machinery, electronics
Fractional Brownian Motion and Fractional Gaussian Noise	Long-range dependence and scale-dependent stochasticity	Network traffic, geophysics, finance
Generalized Autoregressive Conditional Heteroskedasticity	Volatility clustering, heavy tails, and asymmetric shocks	Financial and energy markets
Chaotic	Lorenz, Mackey–Glass, NARMA, and multi-scale oscillatory dynamics	Physical systems, audio, biomedical signals

primitive series is assigned to a root node, while every non-root node is generated from its parents as

$$z_j(t) = \phi_j \left(\sum_{i \in \text{Pa}(j)} w_{ji} z_i(t) \right) + \epsilon_j(t),$$

where $\text{Pa}(j)$ denotes the parents of node j , w_{ji} is a randomly sampled edge weight, and $\epsilon_j(t)$ is additive noise. The nonlinear function ϕ_j is sampled from linear, ReLU, leaky-ReLU, sigmoid, sine, and modulo transformations.

The resulting random SCM combines heterogeneous primitives into higher diverse temporal processes with nonlinear interactions and varying causal graphs. CauKerV2 generates these samples online during pretraining, providing a virtually unlimited synthetic corpus. Although the SCM produces multivariate series, TABBY treats each output channel as an independent univariate training example.

KernelSynth and CauKerV2 play complementary roles in the synthetic pretraining corpus. KernelSynth provides statistically structured, smooth, and quasi-periodic series, whereas CauKerV2 broadens the synthetic distribution to include discontinuities, events, regime changes, long-range dependence, heteroskedasticity, and chaotic dynamics. Importantly, CauKerV2 generates samples online throughout pretraining. This continually refreshed data stream reduces repeated exposure to the same synthetic samples and consequently mitigates overfitting to a finite synthetic dataset. Together, the two generators provide both structured regularity and broad temporal diversity.

6 Pretraining Methodology

This section presents the main components of our pretraining methodology. First, mask sampling combines contiguous internal masks with short terminal masks to balance reconstruction and forecasting while maintaining training stability. Second, our progressive convergence learning rate schedule produces well-annealed

intermediate checkpoints and enables flexible intervention during pretraining. Third, deep quantile supervision directly supervises intermediate layers and regularizes their predictions toward progressive refinement across model depth. Together, these components improve the stability, flexibility, and effectiveness of large scale TSFM pretraining.

6.1 Hybrid Mask Sampling

We train TABBY through masked patch reconstruction, following the general masked modeling paradigm of PatchTST-FM and the Contiguous Patch Masking (CPM) strategy of TiRex (Auer et al., 2025). Given a sequence of patch tokens, we mask contiguous spans and optimize the model only on the masked positions. For an internal span, which can exploit observations on both sides, we mask several contiguous patches; for a terminal span, where the model must extrapolate solely from the preceding context, we restrict its length to at most two patches. We empirically find that longer terminal masks cause substantial training instability, as further examined in Section 9.4. We hypothesize that internal reconstruction provides a better-conditioned learning signal, resembling the bidirectional masked reconstruction objective used by BERT (Devlin et al., 2019), whereas long terminal masks impose a considerably harder extrapolation task. A complete theoretical explanation of this phenomenon remains an important direction for future investigation.

6.2 Progressive Convergence Learning Rate Schedule

Pretraining a TSFM is computationally expensive, making it desirable to obtain well-annealed intermediate checkpoints that can be reliably evaluated throughout training, for example when adjusting hyperparameters or data mixture ratios. Conventional cosine schedules are less suited to this setting because the learning-rate trajectory is tied to a predefined training horizon, leaving intermediate checkpoints only partially annealed. Inspired by Warmup–Stable–Decay (WSD Hu et al. (2024)) and WSD-S (Wen et al., 2024b), we introduce progressive convergence learning rate schedule of a single warm-up phase followed by repeated stable–decay (SD) stages. For stage k , the stable learning rate is $\eta_k = \eta_1 2^{-(k-1)}$, such that each stage operates at half the stable learning rate of its predecessor and ends with a decay phase that produces a locally converged checkpoint. These checkpoints provide explicit intervention points from which training can be evaluated, reconfigured, or continued. As shown in Section 9.1, this schedule provides greater training flexibility while achieving performance comparable to or better than a conventional cosine schedule.

6.3 Deep Quantile Supervision

Recent studies have identified substantial architectural and representational redundancy in TSFMs, showing that intermediate layers can often be removed with only limited performance degradation (Wiliński et al., 2025; Bao et al., 2026). Meanwhile, the functional roles of individual layers remain insufficiently understood. Inspired by deeply supervised learning and the path-interpolation perspective of flow matching (Lipman et al., 2023; Lee et al., 2014; Liu et al., 2022; 2026b), we propose deep quantile supervision. Specifically, we attach a shared quantile decoder to a set of decoded exits $\mathcal{E}$, where M denotes the number of Transformer blocks. Let $\hat{\mathbf{q}}^{(\ell)}$ denote the quantile predictions produced after block ℓ . The terminal exit is optimized using the original quantile objective, while only the intermediate exits receive auxiliary deep supervision:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{DS}} = \sum_{\ell \in \mathcal{E} \setminus \{0, M\}} \left(\frac{\ell}{M} \right)^\gamma \mathcal{L}_{\text{QT}}^{(\ell)}.$$

We additionally regularize each intermediate prediction toward a linear trajectory between the detached initial and terminal predictions:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{q}}^{(\ell)} = \left(1 - \frac{\ell}{M} \right) \text{sg}(\hat{\mathbf{q}}^{(0)}) + \frac{\ell}{M} \text{sg}(\hat{\mathbf{q}}^{(M)}),$$

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{TRA}} = \sum_{\ell \in \mathcal{E} \setminus \{0, M\}} \text{MSE}_\alpha(\hat{\mathbf{q}}^{(\ell)}, \tilde{\mathbf{q}}^{(\ell)}),$$

where $\text{sg}(\cdot)$ denotes the stop-gradient operation and MSE_α denotes the masked, square-root length-weighted MSE defined using the same aggregation as $\mathcal{L}_{\text{QT}}$.

The complete pretraining objective is

$$\mathcal{L} = \mathcal{L}_{\text{QT}}^{(M)} + \lambda_{\text{DS}} \mathcal{L}_{\text{DS}} + \lambda_{\text{TRA}} \mathcal{L}_{\text{TRA}}.$$

For the TABBY model,

$$M = 20, \quad \mathcal{E} = \{0, 5, 10, 15, 20\}, \quad \lambda_{\text{DS}} = 0.5, \quad \lambda_{\text{TRA}} = 0.1, \quad \gamma = 1.$$

Here, exit 0 and exit 20 serve as the trajectory endpoints, while $\{5, 10, 15\}$ are the auxiliary deeply supervised exits.

7 Prompt-Based In-Distribution Tuning

We also design a lightweight, fully reversible form of supervised adaptation for TABBY: prompt tuning of the frozen model. When training data from the target distribution (e.g., GIFT-Eval) is available, a small prompt module can be trained on it to further improve performance without modifying any pretrained parameter.

Module. To introduce soft prompts into the pretrained model, we prepend $M=160$ learnable tokens $P(x) \in \mathbb{R}^{M \times d}$ to the patch-embedding sequence, where d is the latent dimension of the patch embeddings. All prompt tokens are assigned position index 0, so they act as position-agnostic conditioning signals: the history keeps its full context budget and its original positional encoding. The forecasting process then becomes

$$\hat{\mathbf{y}}_{1:H} = f_\theta([P(x); \mathbf{x}_{1:T}]),$$

where f_θ is the frozen backbone, $\mathbf{x}_{1:T}$ is the patch embeddings of the input window x , and $\hat{q}_{1:H}$ denotes the predicted quantiles over the forecast horizon H .

Specifically, the prompt combines a shared component with a gated, input-adaptive one,

$$P(x) = P_{\text{shared}} + \sigma(g) P_{\text{adaptive}}(\mathbf{x}_{1:T}),$$

where $P_{\text{shared}} \in \mathbb{R}^{M \times d}$ is learned during training. g is also a learnable scalar, adjusted by the sigmoid function $\sigma(\cdot)$. The adaptive component is generated from a compact descriptor $s(x) \in \mathbb{R}^{10}$ of the normalized input window, collecting scale-invariant statistics of its location, spread, trend, roughness, autocorrelation and length. A two-layer MLP maps $s(x)$ to the coefficients of a low-rank token basis with $r=4$, following Xiao et al. (2026). Since $s(x)$ is low-dimensional, this factorization keeps the input-dependent part of the module small while still tailoring the prompt to each series.

Training. During the in-distribution tuning, only the prompt module are updated. The backbone model are always frozen. The module is trained with the pretraining quantile (pinball) loss on the training portion of the target data under time-based splits, so no evaluation data is ever seen. A single module is trained once across all training datasets and utilized for every evaluation task. Model selection uses validation loss on held-out windows of the training split. Training costs a few GPU-hours on a single device and can be repeated for any checkpoint of the backbone. In inference the module is strictly optional.

8 Evaluation

8.1 Forecasting

Benchmarks. We evaluate TABBY on two complementary forecasting benchmarks: GIFT-Eval, and TIME. GIFT-Eval (Aksu et al., 2024) contains 23 datasets covering more than 144,000 time series across seven domains and ten sampling frequencies, with forecasting horizons ranging from short to long term. TIME (Qiao et al., 2026) is a task-centric benchmark containing 50 recently collected datasets and 98 forecasting

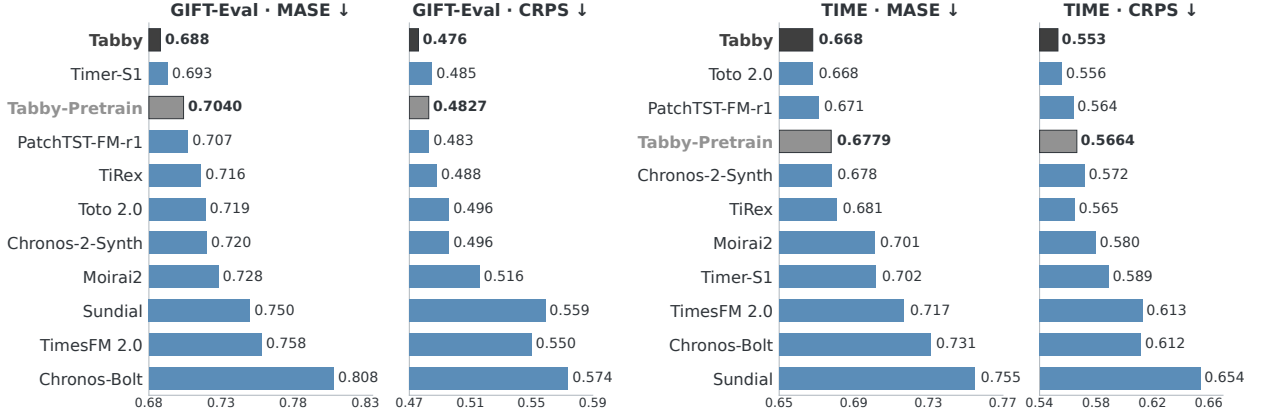


Figure 2: Forecasting performance on GIFT-Eval (ID) and TIME (OOD). Models are ordered by MASE within each benchmark.

tasks. It emphasizes data freshness, data integrity, providing a stringent evaluation with a substantially reduced risk of pretraining-data contamination.

We use the terms in-distribution and out-of-distribution to describe the relationship between a benchmark and the pretraining corpus. Since our real-world pretraining corpus is largely derived from GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ and BLAST, and TABBY is prompt-tuned on GIFT-Eval training set, we consider GIFT-Eval as an in-distribution benchmark. In contrast, TIME consists primarily of newly collected data sources released after many existing TSFMs were developed and therefore serves as our main out-of-distribution benchmark.

Evaluation Metrics. We primarily evaluate point and probabilistic forecasting performance using Mean Absolute Scaled Error (MASE) and Continuous Ranked Probability Score (CRPS), respectively. For a historical context $\mathbf{x}_{1:T}$, a forecast horizon H , and seasonal period m , MASE and CRPS are defined as

$$\text{MASE} = \frac{\frac{1}{H} \sum_{h=1}^H |y_{T+h} - \hat{y}_{T+h}|}{\frac{1}{T-m} \sum_{t=m}^T |x_t - x_{t-m}|}, \quad \text{CRPS} \approx \frac{2}{H|\mathcal{Q}|} \sum_{h=1}^H \sum_{\tau \in \mathcal{Q}} \rho_{\tau} \left(y_{T+h} - \hat{q}_{T+h}^{(\tau)} \right) \quad (1)$$

where the median forecast is used as the point prediction $\hat{y}_{T+h}$. MASE is scale independent and measures forecasting error relative to an in-sample seasonal-naive predictor. Values below one indicate an improvement over the seasonal-naive reference. Because TABBY directly predicts quantiles, we compute CRPS using its discrete quantile approximation, where $\mathcal{Q}$ denotes the quantile grid required by each benchmark and ρ_{τ} is the pinball loss.

Main Results. Figure 2 compares TABBY with recent state-of-the-art time-series foundation models. On the in-distribution GIFT-Eval benchmark, TABBY outperforms Sundial, TimesFM 2.5, and Chronos-Bolt on both metrics. On the out-of-distribution TIME benchmark, TABBY consistently outperforming Moirai-2.0, Sundial, TimesFM 2.5, and Chronos-Bolt. These results indicate that the balanced pretraining corpus and the proposed training methodology provide competitive forecasting performance.

8.2 Representation

Benchmarks and Evaluation Metrics We investigate whether the representations learned by TABBY transfer to time series classification. We evaluate the frozen encoder on all 128 datasets in the UCR Archive (Dau et al., 2019). We refer to this setting as zero-shot representation learning: the pretrained encoder receives no classification-specific training and is never updated using UCR labels, although a supervised classifier is fitted on the official training split of each downstream dataset. For each dataset, missing observations are interpolated and every time series is linearly resized to a fixed length (1,024 time steps). The resulting sequence is right-aligned within the model context window and passed through the frozen

Table 2: Mean classification accuracy over all 128 datasets in the UCR Archive.

	Catch22+	TabPFN	TabICL	MOMENT	TiViT-H	NuTime	MantisV1	TABBY
UCR	0.7969	0.7806	0.7707	0.7789	0.7943	0.7732	0.7816	0.7999

Transformer encoder. The forecasting quantile head is discarded. Let $\mathbf{H}_i^{(\ell)} \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times d}$ denote the patch representations of sample i after Transformer layer ℓ , and let $\mathcal{V}_i$ denote the set of non-padding patches. We first obtain one representation from each layer using padding-aware mean pooling:

$$\mathbf{r}_i^{(\ell)} = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{V}_i|} \sum_{j \in \mathcal{V}_i} \mathbf{H}_{i,j}^{(\ell)}.$$

Representations from different depths may encode complementary temporal information. Instead of selecting a single intermediate layer, we concatenate the pooled representations from all M Transformer layers:

$$\mathbf{z}_i = \mathbf{r}_i^{(1)} \parallel \mathbf{r}_i^{(2)} \parallel \dots \parallel \mathbf{r}_i^{(M)} \in \mathbb{R}^{Md},$$

where $\parallel$ denotes feature concatenation. This layer-fusion strategy uses every depth uniformly and requires neither dataset-specific layer selection nor validation on the test split. For each UCR dataset, a Random Forest is trained on the fused representations and labels from its official training split. The fitted classifier is then evaluated once on the official test split. The pretrained encoder remains frozen throughout the entire procedure, and neither test labels nor test accuracy are used for model or representation selection.

Main Results Table 2 reports the unweighted mean test accuracy over all 128 UCR datasets. Without any classification-specific pretraining or encoder adaptation, TABBY achieves an average accuracy of 0.7999. It outperforms Catch22+(Lubba et al., 2019), TabPFN(Hollmann et al., 2023), TabICL(Qu et al., 2025), MOMENT(Goswami et al., 2024), TiViT-H(Roschmann et al., 2025), NuTime(Lin et al., 2024), and Mantis(Feofanov et al., 2026), showing that TABBY pretraining produces representations that transfer effectively to classification.

8.3 Anomaly Detection

We next ask whether TABBY’s representations also transfer to anomaly detection, a task where many pre-trained models have been reported to struggle against simple statistical detectors (Liu & Paparrizos, 2024). We evaluate on TSB-AD-U (Liu & Paparrizos, 2024), a curated univariate benchmark, and report VUS-PR (Paparrizos et al., 2022), which the benchmark identifies as its most reliable measure.

As in Section 8.2, we discard the quantile head and score in representation space. Each series is tiled into non-overlapping context windows, and the patch embeddings from the final transformer block are pooled across all windows into $\mathbf{Z} = [\mathbf{z}_1, \dots, \mathbf{z}_{n_p}]^\top \in \mathbb{R}^{n_p \times d}$. We then fit a Gaussian to the series’ own embeddings and score each patch by its Mahalanobis distance to it,

$$a_i = \sqrt{\max\{(\mathbf{z}_i - \boldsymbol{\mu})^\top \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_\lambda^+(\mathbf{z}_i - \boldsymbol{\mu}), 0\}},$$

with shrinkage $\lambda = 0.1$ and a pseudo-inverse for stability. Scores are broadcast to the timesteps of their patch and min-max scaled. The model is frozen and no labels are used; the only per-series estimation is $\boldsymbol{\mu}, \boldsymbol{\Sigma}$, which assumes anomalies are a minority of the series. The distance metric was selected on the 48-series tuning split and all reported numbers are on the held-out evaluation split. Further details are given in Appendix F.

Main Results Table 3 reports the mean VUS-PR over the 350 evaluation series. TABBY attains 0.4282, ahead of the general-purpose foundation models evaluated zero-shot on this benchmark, including MOMENT (Goswami et al., 2024), TimesFM (Das et al., 2024), Chronos (Ansari et al., 2024) and Lag-Llama (Rasul et al., 2024). It also exceeds MOMENT in its fine-tuned form and xLSTMAD (Faber et al., 2025), a

Table 3: Mean VUS-PR over the TSB-AD-U evaluation split. Baseline numbers are taken from the TSB-AD leaderboard.

	Lag-Llama	Chronos	TimesFM	MOMENT (ZS)	MOMENT (FT)	xLSTMAD	TSPulse	TABBY
TSB-AD-U	0.27	0.27	0.30	0.38	0.39	0.40	0.48	0.43

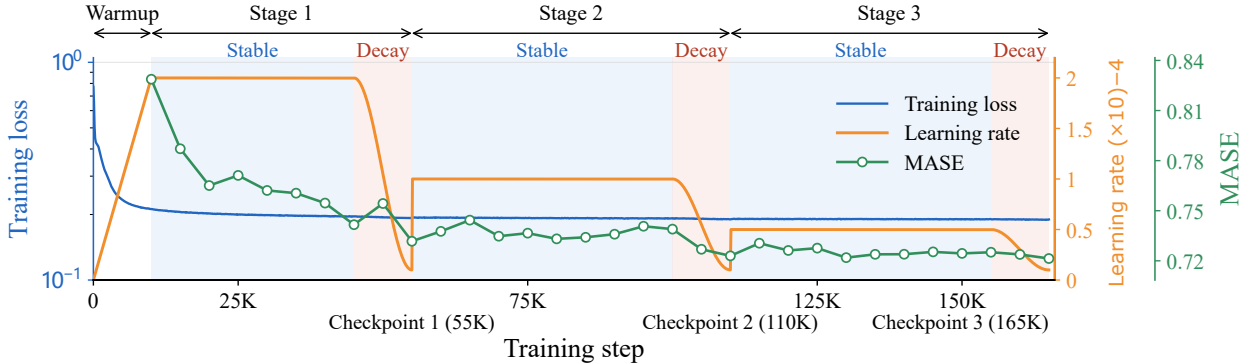


Figure 3: MASE is evaluated on Gift-Eval benchmark. Each stable phase is followed by a decay phase, producing a locally converged intermediate checkpoint.

purpose-built reconstruction detector trained on each target series, indicating that the gain comes from the representation rather than from adaptation to the target data. Stronger results come from methods that add task-specific specialisation TABBY does not use: TSPulse (Ekambaram et al., 2026) pairs a masked-reconstruction model with a detection-specific scoring pipeline, while CHARM (Pastrana et al., 2026) and Time-RCD (Lan et al., 2025) rely respectively on anomaly-free reference data from the target series and on pretraining with anomaly labels. TABBY estimates its reference distribution from the full series it scores, without labels or clean reference data.

9 Analysis

Reference Model for Analysis. Due to the computational cost of repeatedly pretraining the full TABBY model, the following analyses are conducted using a smaller reference model, denoted as TABBY-SMALL. It contains 40.291M parameters and consists of 12 Transformer layers with a hidden dimension of 512. The model is pretrained for 110,000 optimization steps using eight GPUs and a global batch size of 512. Unless otherwise specified, all ablation studies use the same architecture, data mixture, masking strategy, and optimization configuration, changing only the component under investigation. The complete architecture and pretraining configuration of TABBY-SMALL are provided in Appendix C.

9.1 Analysis of Progressive Convergence Schedule

Stage-End Convergence. Large-scale TSFM pretraining requires intermediate checkpoints that are not merely arbitrary checkpoint, but locally annealed states suitable for reliable evaluation and subsequent continuation. In the pretraining of TABBY, we begin with a warm up. The schedule contains three stable-decay stages. Figure 3 shows the complete training trajectory over optimization steps. The training loss remains smooth across the entire trajectory. In particular, the learning rate changes discontinuously at 55K and 110K steps: it is raised from the decay to the stable rate of the next stage. Nevertheless, neither transition produces a visible loss spike or a sustained increase in optimization noise. The model therefore remains stable when training is resumed from a stage-end checkpoint. Within each stable phase, the loss decreases gradually and eventually approaches a relatively flat region. The subsequent decay reduces the update magnitude and produces an additional decrease before the curve reaches a new plateau. Every decay phase yields a competitive checkpoint, while later stages continue to improve upon the preceding one.

Matched-Budget Scheduler Comparison. We further compare the proposed schedule with Cosine (Wen et al., 2026) and WSD-S (Wen et al., 2024a) learning rate schedule using TABBY-SMALL at the same training budget of 110K steps. Both variants use the same pretraining pipeline, changing only the learning-rate schedule. Table 4 reports the MASE and CRPS on GIFT-Eval benchmark. In our situation, the PCS reduces MASE and CRPS, the proposed schedule improves both point and probabilistic forecasting scores over Cosine and WSD-S schedule.

Table 4: Learning rate ablation.

Schedule	MASE	CRPS
WSD-S	0.7551	0.5165
Cosine	0.7456	0.5112
PCS	0.7368	0.5038

Sensitivity to aggressive restarts. A further motivation for decreasing the peak learning rate across stable-decay stages is that later checkpoints become less tolerant of aggressive restarts. We test this hypothesis using short restart probes from the 55K and 110K checkpoints of TABBY-SMALL and from the 55K, 110K, and 165K checkpoints of the TABBY model. For each checkpoint, we restore both the model and AdamW states and continue training with $\eta_{\text{peak}} \in \{10^{-5}, 2.5 \times 10^{-5}, 5 \times 10^{-5}, 10^{-4}, 2 \times 10^{-4}\}$. Each branch consists of 1K constant rate updates followed by a 500 step cosine cooldown

Table 5: Sensitivity to restart peak learning rates. G_0 is the validation loss obtained with $\eta_{\text{peak}} = 10^{-5}$; the remaining columns report the relative increase over G_0 .

Model	Start	G_0	$\Delta_{5 \times 10^{-5}}$	$\Delta_{10^{-4}}$	$\Delta_{2 \times 10^{-4}}$
Small	55K	0.09618	+0.42%	+1.15%	+2.49%
Small	110K	0.09464	+0.63%	+1.58%	+3.22%
Main	55K	0.09031	+0.44%	+1.25%	+2.65%
Main	110K	0.08856	+0.60%	+1.53%	+3.60%
Main	165K	0.08793	+0.69%	+1.57%	+3.63%

to 10^{-5} and is evaluated on the same fixed pretraining-distribution validation probe. Table 5 reports the relative increase in weighted validation loss with respect to the $\eta_{\text{peak}} = 10^{-5}$ continuation. This reduced tolerance to large restart updates motivates progressively attenuating the peak learning rate rather than repeatedly restoring its initial value. The increasingly steep response curves show that restoring an early-stage peak becomes progressively more disruptive. This observation provides a mechanistic motivation for using smaller restart peaks at later stages. Complete settings and results are provided in Appendix H.

9.2 Analysis of Deep Quantile Supervision

Forecasting Performance Comparison. We compare TABBY-SMALL with and without deep quantile supervision at the same training budget of 110K steps. Both variants use the same architecture, data mixture, masking strategy, and learning rate schedule. Table 6 reports the MASE and weighted quantile loss over the same 97 GIFT-Eval evaluation entries. Removing DQS increases MASE and CRPS by 1.47% and 1.57%, respectively, supporting the benefit of deep quantile supervision for both point and probabilistic forecasting on GIFT-Eval.

Table 6: GIFT-Eval DQS ablation.

Setting	MASE	CRPS
Without DQS	0.7476	0.5117
With DQS	0.7368	0.5038

Functional Utility of Intermediate Blocks. We assess the functional utility of intermediate blocks by bypassing one block at a time during inference, without fine-tuning. Table 7 presents the results for layers 6 to 8, using the zero-based indexing of Appendix E. Each relative change is measured against the corresponding checkpoint with all blocks retained.

Table 7: Functional ablation of intermediate blocks on GIFT-Eval. Positive values indicate degradation.

Skipped layer	$\Delta\text{MASE} (\%)$		$\Delta\text{CRPS} (\%)$	
	w/ DQS	w/o DQS	w/ DQS	w/o DQS
6	+1.13	+0.11	+0.91	-0.05
7	+1.52	+0.09	+1.07	-0.14
8	+1.63	+0.93	+1.45	+0.92

Without DQS, bypassing layers 6 and 7 has little effect on aggregate MASE and slightly improves CRPS. With DQS, bypassing either block increases MASE by 1.13%–1.52%. Bypassing layer 8 also causes larger degradation with DQS than without it. These results suggest that DQS encourages useful transformations at intermediate depth and reduces local functional redundancy in the tested checkpoints. This interpretation

concerns aggregate sensitivity to single-block removal; it does not imply that blocks with small aggregate effects are irrelevant to every dataset. Full experimental settings and layer-wise results are provided in Appendix E.

DQS Improve the Local Update Direction The model-level ablation shows that DQS improves the final forecasting performance, but it does not identify why. One possible explanation is purely scalar: adding the auxiliary loss may only increase the gradient norm and therefore induce a larger effective step. We test the stronger hypothesis that DQS changes the update direction itself and makes it more favorable to the held-out final forecasting objective.

We conduct an optimizer-aware, one-step intervention at the TABBY-SMALL checkpoint. From the same parameters, AdamW state, update batch, and mask realization, we construct three branches: final supervision only (A), a norm-matched rescaling of the final-loss gradient (M), and final supervision plus DQS (B). M has the same raw gradient norm as B but preserves the direction of the final-loss gradient. After applying the same stored AdamW moments and clipping rule, we additionally normalize the three actual parameter displacements to the same radius. We then evaluate the final pinball loss on temporally disjoint held-out windows that are not used to construct the update. The experiment uses 23 sufficiently long GIFT-Eval configurations from 16 original dataset groups, with four paired trials per configuration and radius multipliers $\rho \in \{0.25, 0.5, 1\}$. Full details are provided in Appendix G.

Table 8: Optimizer-aware one-step DQS intervention. Entries are the macro-average relative reduction in final validation pinball loss; a positive value favors the DQS branch B. Parentheses give 95% confidence intervals from paired original-dataset cluster bootstrap.

Radius ρ	B over A (%)	B over norm-matched M (%)
0.25	0.00712 [0.00112, 0.01499]	0.00663 [0.00124, 0.01373]
0.50	0.01399 [0.00253, 0.02873]	0.01296 [0.00251, 0.02594]
1.00	0.02698 [0.00470, 0.05446]	0.02477 [0.00485, 0.04930]

The norm-matched comparison is the key control. The DQS gradient increases the raw gradient norm by approximately 43.2%, but M reproduces this norm without adding the DQS direction; A and M are statistically indistinguishable, whereas B remains better than M after the actual parameter displacement is matched. Moreover, the cosine similarity between the final and DQS gradients is 0.717, showing that DQS contributes a substantial non-parallel component. After AdamW preconditioning, B improves update-validation-gradient alignment over M. These results provide direct local evidence that DQS supplies a more favorable update direction beyond its effect on gradient magnitude. They do not, by themselves, establish that every DQS step decreases held-out loss: at $\rho = 1$, the loss reduction of B relative to making no update has a positive point estimate but a confidence interval that narrowly includes zero. The claim is therefore local and comparative, complementing rather than replacing the end-to-end DQS ablation.

9.3 Analysis of CauKerV2

We evaluate the contribution of CauKerV2 by removing its 10% sampling share and redistributing it to GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+. Its shares therefore increase from 25% to 35% each, while KernelSynth remains at 30%. All other settings remain unchanged, including the 110K-step training budget.

Table 9: CauKerV2 ablation.

Setting	MASE	CRPS
Without CauKerV2	0.7536	0.5109
With CauKerV2	0.7368	0.5038

As shown in Table 9, removing CauKerV2 increases MASE and CRPS by 2.29% and 1.42%, respectively. Replacing CauKerV2 with additional real-world samples therefore degrades both point and probabilistic forecasting performance. These results suggest that CauKerV2 provides a complementary training signal beyond simply increasing the proportion of real-world data.

9.4 Analysis of Terminal Mask Length

We examine the effect of longer extrapolation targets during pretraining by increasing the maximum terminal mask length from 2 to 32 patches. Both variants use TABBY-SMALL and the same 110K-step training budget, with all other settings unchanged.

As shown in Table 10, increasing the terminal mask length raises MASE and CRPS by 1.43% and 1.55%, respectively. Thus, longer extrapolation targets do not improve forecasting performance under the same training budget. These results support restricting terminal masks to short spans within our hybrid masking strategy.

Table 10: Terminal mask ablation.

Max. patches	MASE	CRPS
32	0.7473	0.5116
2	0.7368	0.5038

10 Limitations

Our study has several limitations. First, TABBY adopts a channel-independent architecture and does not explicitly model cross-variable dependencies or external covariates. Second, computational constraints limit the scope of our ablations. Controlled comparisons are conducted primarily with TABBY-SMALL at a fixed training budget. Third, our data mixture and synthetic generators encode manually chosen priors. Although the CauKerV2 ablation supports its complementarity to real world data, it does not isolate the contributions of individual generator families, structural composition, or online sampling.

11 Conclusion

We presented TABBY, a time series foundation model built on patch Transformer, together with an open pretraining recipe covering data construction, training, and evaluation. The recipe combines curated real world data with KernelSynth and CauKerV2, a multi-stage learning-rate schedule that produces reusable intermediate checkpoints, and quantile deep supervision that directly trains intermediate predictions.

Experiments demonstrate competitive forecasting, classification transfer through frozen representations, and zero-shot anomaly detection. Controlled ablations support the contributions of progressive convergence learning rate schedule, deep quantile supervision, and CauKerV2. By releasing the model and the complete pipeline, we aim to make TSFM pretraining easier to reproduce and extend, and to provide a foundation for further research on synthetic data, training objectives.

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A Model Architecture Details

A.1 Input window and mask-aware normalization

Let

$$n_o = \sum_{t=1}^{L_{\max}} o_t, \quad \bar{n}_o = \max(n_o, 1),$$

and compute

$$\mu = \frac{1}{\bar{n}_o} \sum_{t=1}^{L_{\max}} o_t x_t, \quad v = \frac{1}{\bar{n}_o} \sum_{t=1}^{L_{\max}} o_t (x_t - \mu)^2.$$

The scale used by the released training and evaluation implementation is

$$\bar{s} = \begin{cases} \sqrt{v + \epsilon}, & n_o \geq 2, \\ 1, & n_o < 2, \end{cases} \quad \epsilon = 10^{-5}.$$

The normalized input and inverse transformation are

$$z_t = \text{asinh} \left(\frac{x_t - \mu}{\bar{s}} \right), \quad \tilde{z}_t = o_t z_t,$$

$$\hat{x}_{t,\tau} = \mu + \bar{s} \sinh(\hat{z}_{t,\tau}).$$

A.2 Patch encoder

The window is split into $N = L/P$ non-overlapping patches of length P . For patch n , we concatenate its normalized values and visibility indicators:

$$\mathbf{u}_n = [\tilde{\mathbf{z}}_n; \mathbf{o}_n] \in \mathbb{R}^{2P}. \quad (2)$$

Each patch is mapped to the model dimension by a residual two-layer projection,

$$\phi_{\text{in}}(\mathbf{u}) = \mathbf{W}_2 \sigma(\mathbf{W}_1 \mathbf{u} + \mathbf{b}_1) + \mathbf{b}_2 + \mathbf{W}_r \mathbf{u} + \mathbf{b}_r, \quad (3)$$

where σ is the sigmoid function. The initial representation is

$$\mathbf{h}_n^{(0)} = \phi_{\text{in}}(\mathbf{u}_n) + \mathbf{e}_n, \quad (4)$$

where $\mathbf{e}_n \in \mathbb{R}^d$ is a learned absolute positional embedding. Padded patches are excluded as attention keys, while attention among all non-padded patches is bidirectional and non-causal.

A.3 Transformer encoder

The encoder contains M pre-normalization Transformer blocks. For layer $\ell = 1, \dots, M$,

$$\mathbf{a}^{(\ell)} = \mathbf{h}^{(\ell-1)} + \text{MHA}(\text{LN}(\mathbf{h}^{(\ell-1)})), \quad (5)$$

$$\mathbf{h}^{(\ell)} = \mathbf{a}^{(\ell)} + \text{Dropout}(\text{FFN}(\text{LN}(\mathbf{a}^{(\ell)}))). \quad (6)$$

Multi-head self-attention uses $n_h = d/d_h$ heads. The feed-forward network has hidden width $4d$ and a GELU activation. No causal mask is used; information leakage is prevented by zeroing the withheld values and providing only their visibility indicators to the encoder.

A.4 Monotone quantile decoder

Let K be the number of predicted quantiles. A residual output projection maps each final patch representation to $P(K+1)$ raw values. After reshaping, let $r_{n,j,0}, \dots, r_{n,j,K}$ denote the raw outputs for offset j within patch n . The normalized quantile predictions are

$$\hat{z}_{n,j,k} = r_{n,j,0} + \sum_{i=1}^k \frac{\text{softplus}(r_{n,j,i})}{K}, \quad k = 1, \dots, K. \quad (7)$$

Because every increment is positive, $\hat{z}_{n,j,k+1} \geq \hat{z}_{n,j,k}$, so quantile crossing cannot occur. With $K = 99$, the modeled levels are

$$\tau_k = \frac{k}{K+1} = \frac{k}{100}, \quad k = 1, \dots, 99, \quad (8)$$

covering 0.01 through 0.99. These outputs represent pointwise conditional marginal quantiles; the model does not define a joint distribution over the forecast horizon.

A.5 Forecast-window construction and multivariate inputs

For a requested forecast horizon H , the inference wrapper reserves

$$F = \max(H, P \max(B_{\text{cpm}}, 2)) = \max(H, 128) \quad (9)$$

masked positions, where $P = 16$ and $B_{\text{cpm}} = 8$. It retains at most $L - F$ recent observations, left-pads shorter inputs, appends the F masked positions, and returns the first H forecasts. Consequently, $L = 8192$ is the total model window rather than the number of historical observations always available to the encoder.

For a multivariate input $\mathbf{X} \in \mathbb{R}^{B \times L \times D_v}$, the implementation reshapes the input to $(BD_v) \times L$, applies the same univariate backbone to every channel, and then restores the channel dimension. Normalization statistics are computed separately for each channel. Hence, all channels share model parameters, but there is no cross-channel attention in the current architecture.

The inference interface optionally provides a single-value summary of the predicted quantiles using symmetric triangular weights:

$$\hat{y}_t^{\text{tri}} = \sum_{k=1}^K w_k \hat{q}_{t,\tau_k}, \quad w_k = \frac{0.5 - |0.5 - \tau_k|}{\sum_{i=1}^K (0.5 - |0.5 - \tau_i|)}. \quad (10)$$

This aggregation assigns larger weights to quantiles near the center of the predictive distribution. It is provided as an optional point summary and should not be interpreted as the predictive mean. In all forecasting results reported in this work, including MASE, we instead use the median forecast,

$$\hat{y}_t^{\text{median}} = \hat{q}_{t,0.5}. \quad (11)$$

A.6 Configuration and parameter count

The exact parameter decomposition is reported in Table 12. The input projection receives $2P = 32$ features per patch, and the output projection produces $P(K+1) = 1600$ raw values per patch.

The state dictionary contains 253 parameter tensors. Storing the parameters alone requires approximately 556.348 MiB in FP32 or 278.174 MiB in BF16; these figures exclude gradients, optimizer states, and activations.

B GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+: Real-World Data Corpora

Corpus scope. GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ is the curated real-world component used in our pretraining corpora. It starts from the stored GIFT-Eval-Pretrain collection (Aksu et al., 2024), restores a small set of eligible real-world series removed during earlier filtering, and adds complementary datasets selected from the TiRex-2

Table 11: Architecture configuration of TABBY.

Hyperparameter	Value
Complete model window L	8192
Patch length P	16
Number of patch tokens $N = L/P$	512
Transformer layers M	20
Model dimension d	768
Attention heads n_h	12
Head dimension d_h	64
Feed-forward width	3072
Dropout	0.1
Quantile levels K	99
Pretraining mask ratio	0.4
Contiguous-mask setting B_{cpm}	8 patches
Normalization stabilizer ϵ	10^{-5}

Table 12: Parameter decomposition of TABBY.

Component	Parameters	Share
Input residual projection	641,280	0.44%
Learned positional embedding	393,216	0.27%
20 Transformer blocks	141,757,440	97.20%
Output residual projection	3,051,392	2.09%
Total	145,843,328	100.00%

training corpora (Podest et al., 2026). The final on-disk corpus contains 150 source-dataset entries organized into 134 training sampling units. The difference arises because several small, semantically related datasets are stored in a shared directory and distinguished by a `source_dataset` field. These consolidated directories are sampled as single training units under the balanced sampling scheme described in the main text.

Counting convention. For dataset d , let N_d denote the number of stored Hugging Face rows (samples). If sample n contains C_{dn} channels of length T_{dn} , we report

$$C_d = \sum_{n=1}^{N_d} C_{dn}, \quad P_d = \sum_{n=1}^{N_d} C_{dn} T_{dn}, \quad \bar{T}_d = \frac{P_d}{C_d}.$$

Here, C_d is the number of univariate channel sequences, P_d is the number of scalar observations, and $\bar{T}_d$ is the channel-weighted mean sequence length. This distinction is necessary because one stored sample may contain multiple channels. In Table 15, U denotes entries with $C_d = N_d$, while M denotes entries with $C_d > N_d$. The U/M flag therefore describes the stored target representation rather than the forecasting protocol used downstream.

Overall characteristics. The corpus contains 3,792,438 samples, 28,872,274 channel sequences, and 229,802,174,843 scalar observations. The global channel-weighted mean length is 7,959.27 observations. Dataset-level mean lengths range from 48.95 to 538,725.31 observations, covering both short forecasting collections and very long sensor or power-generation records. Seventy-three stored dataset entries contain multichannel samples; together, they contribute 203,407,137,243 observations (88.5% of the corpus). The collection spans energy, climate and environment, transportation, web and cloud operations, sales, economics and finance, healthcare, tourism, and natural phenomena, with sampling intervals ranging from seconds to quarterly observations. The scan found no malformed targets.

All counts below describe the post-curation files actually used by our data loader; they need not match the raw upstream releases because filtering, restoration, sharding, and channel expansion are applied before pretraining.

B.1 Consolidation into Training Sampling Units

Uniform sampling over source datasets can severely oversample very small collections. We therefore consolidate selected small datasets before constructing the balanced sampler. The consolidation is performed only at the sampling-unit level: the original dataset identity is retained in the `source_dataset` field, and all samples remain individually recoverable. Table 13 reports every composite unit found in the final training manifest.

The first three units group datasets from the same or closely related application areas. The recovered-real unit instead groups datasets by curation provenance: these datasets were restored after an earlier filtering stage and are not assumed to belong to a single application domain.

Table 13: Source datasets consolidated into shared training sampling units. The row count is the number of stored Hugging Face samples in the composite unit.

Training sampling unit	Constituent source datasets	Rows
<code>energy_covariates_small</code>	<code>cockatoo</code> , <code>covid19_energy</code> , <code>gfc14_load</code> , <code>pdb</code> , <code>spain</code> , and <code>spanish_energy_and_weather</code>	129
<code>macro_finance_small</code>	<code>bitcoin_with_missing</code> , <code>exchange_rate</code> , and <code>monash_fred_md</code>	321
<code>public_health_small</code>	<code>cdc_fluview_ilinet</code> , <code>cdc_fluview_who_nrevss</code> , and <code>covid_mobility</code>	1,304
<code>recovered_useful_real</code>	<code>HZMETRO</code> , <code>SHMETRO</code> , <code>borealis</code> , <code>elecddemand</code> , <code>elf</code> , <code>smart</code> , <code>solar_power</code> , and <code>wind_power</code>	4,096

Table 14: Composition of GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ by collection source. Mean length is computed as total observations divided by total channel sequences.

Code	Collection component	Entries	Samples	Channels	Observations
G	Stored GIFT-Eval subset	120	3,782,761	28,855,468	228,829,433,709
T	TiRex-2 supplement	21	5,474	12,603	943,028,306
R	Restored curated subset	9	4,203	4,203	29,712,828
Total	GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+	150	3,792,438	28,872,274	229,802,174,843

Frequency notation. *s*, *min*, *h*, *d*, *wk*, *mo*, and *qtr* denote seconds, minutes, hours, days, weeks, months, and quarters, respectively. Frequencies record the nominal sampling interval of the stored source dataset; they are not resampling factors applied by the model.

Table 15: Complete dataset-level inventory of GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+. Source codes follow Table 14. Samples are stored rows; channels are univariate sequences after expanding the target dimension; mean length is P_d/C_d ; and observations count every scalar value across all channels.

Dataset	Src.	Domain	Freq.	Type	Samples	Channels	Mean length	Observations
BEIJING_SUBWAY_30MIN	T	Transport	30 min	M	276	552	1,572.00	867,744
PEMS04	T	Transport	5 min	M	307	921	16,992.00	15,649,632
PEMS08	T	Transport	5 min	M	170	510	17,856.00	9,106,560
beijing_air_quality	T	Environment	1 h	M	12	132	35,064.00	4,628,448
china_air_quality	T	Environment	1 h	M	437	2,622	13,133.26	34,435,404
cockatoo	T	Energy	1 h	U	6	6	17,544.00	105,264
covid19_energy	T	Energy	1 h	U	14	14	31,912.00	446,768
gfc14_load	T	Energy	1 h	U	1	1	17,520.00	17,520
pdb	T	Energy	1 h	U	2	2	17,520.00	35,040
spain	T	Energy	1 h	U	4	4	35,064.00	140,256
spanish_energy_and_weather	T	Energy	1 h	U	102	102	35,064.00	3,576,528
bitcoin_with_missing	R	Econ./finance	1 d	U	107	107	4,551.00	486,957
exchange_rate	T	Econ./finance	1 d	U	107	107	7,588.00	811,916
monash_fred_md	T	Econ./finance	1 mo	U	107	107	728.00	77,896
project_tycho	T	Healthcare	1 wk	U	1,258	1,258	1,095.16	1,377,707
cdc_fluview_ilinet	T	Healthcare	1 wk	U	646	646	887.00	573,000
cdc_fluview_who_nrevss	T	Healthcare	1 wk	U	296	296	564.32	167,040
covid_mobility	T	Transport	1 d	U	362	362	410.50	148,602
HZMETRO	R	Transport	15 min	U	512	512	2,377.00	1,217,024
SHMETRO	R	Transport	15 min	U	512	512	8,192.00	4,194,304
borealis	R	Energy	1 h	U	512	512	5,552.78	2,843,023
elecddemand	R	Energy	30 min	U	512	512	8,192.00	4,194,304
elf	R	Energy	1 h	U	512	512	8,192.00	4,194,304
smart	R	Energy	1 h	U	512	512	8,192.00	4,194,304
solar_power	R	Energy	4 s	U	512	512	8,192.00	4,194,304
wind_power	R	Energy	4 s	U	512	512	8,192.00	4,194,304
residential_load_power	T	Energy	1 min	M	271	813	538,725.31	437,983,677
residential_pv_power	T	Energy	1 min	M	233	699	537,935.41	376,016,850
subseasonal	T	Climate	1 d	M	862	3,448	16,470.00	56,788,560
sunspot_with_missing	T	Nature	1 d	U	1	1	73,894.00	73,894
mexico_city_bikes	G	Transport	1 h	U	494	494	78,313.77	38,687,004
ushcn_daily	G	Climate	1 d	U	1,218	1,218	38,653.62	47,080,115
weatherbench_daily	G	Climate	1 d	U	225,280	225,280	14,609.98	3,291,336,704
weatherbench_weekly	G	Climate	1 wk	U	225,280	225,280	2,087.00	470,159,360
LOS_LOOP	G	Transport	5 min	U	207	207	34,272.00	7,094,304
PEMS03	G	Transport	5 min	U	358	358	26,208.00	9,382,464
PEMS07	G	Transport	5 min	U	883	883	28,224.00	24,921,792
PEMS_BAY	G	Transport	5 min	U	325	325	52,128.00	16,941,600
Q-TRAFFIC	G	Transport	15 min	U	45,148	45,148	5,856.00	264,386,688
alibaba_cluster_trace_2018	G	Cloud operations	5 min	M	58,409	116,818	1,629.76	190,385,060
australian_electricity_demand	G	Energy	30 min	U	5	5	230,716.80	1,153,584
azure_vm_traces_2017	G	Cloud operations	5 min	U	159,472	159,472	5,552.84	885,522,908
bdg-2_bear	G	Energy	1 h	U	91	91	16,289.14	1,482,312
bdg-2_fox	G	Energy	1 h	U	135	135	17,219.02	2,324,568
bdg-2_panther	G	Energy	1 h	U	105	105	8,760.00	919,800
bdg-2_rat	G	Energy	1 h	U	280	280	16,886.74	4,728,288
borg_cluster_data_2011	G	Cloud operations	5 min	M	143,386	286,772	3,748.99	1,075,105,708

Continued on next page

Table 15 – continued from previous page

Dataset	Src.	Domain	Freq.	Type	Samples	Channels	Mean length	Observations
buildings_900k	G	Energy	1 h	U	1,795,256	1,795,256	8,761.00	15,728,237,816
bull	G	Energy	1 h	U	41	41	17,544.00	719,304
cmip6_1850	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1855	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1860	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1865	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1870	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1875	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1880	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1885	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1890	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1895	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1900	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1905	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1910	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1915	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1920	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1925	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1930	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1935	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1940	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1945	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1950	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1955	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1960	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1965	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1970	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1975	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1980	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1985	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1990	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_1995	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_2000	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_2005	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
cmip6_2010	G	Climate	6 h	M	8,192	434,176	7,300.00	3,169,484,800
era5_1989	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_1990	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_1991	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_1992	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_1993	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_1994	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_1995	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_1996	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_1997	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_1998	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_1999	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2000	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2001	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2002	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2003	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2004	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040

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Table 15 – continued from previous page

Dataset	Src.	Domain	Freq.	Type	Samples	Channels	Mean length	Observations
era5_2005	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2006	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2007	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2008	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2009	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2010	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2011	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2012	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2013	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2014	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2015	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2016	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2017	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
era5_2018	G	Climate	1 h	M	8,192	368,640	8,736.00	3,220,439,040
extended_web_traffic_with_missing	G	Web	1 d	U	145,063	145,063	2,557.00	370,926,091
favorita_sales	G	Sales/retail	1 d	U	111,840	111,840	1,244.45	139,179,538
favorita_transactions	G	Sales/retail	1 d	U	54	54	1,563.11	84,408
gfc12_load	G	Energy	1 h	U	20	20	39,414.00	788,280
gfc17_load	G	Energy	1 h	U	8	8	17,544.00	140,352
hog	G	Energy	1 h	U	24	24	17,544.00	421,056
ideal	G	Energy	1 h	U	217	217	5,784.58	1,255,253
kaggle_web_traffic_weekly	G	Web	1 wk	U	145,063	145,063	114.00	16,537,182
kdd2022	G	Energy	10 min	U	134	134	35,279.99	4,727,519
largest_2017	G	Transport	5 min	U	8,196	8,196	105,120.00	861,563,520
largest_2018	G	Transport	5 min	U	8,428	8,428	105,120.00	885,951,360
largest_2019	G	Transport	5 min	U	8,600	8,600	105,120.00	904,032,000
largest_2020	G	Transport	5 min	U	8,561	8,561	105,408.00	902,397,888
largest_2021	G	Transport	5 min	U	8,548	8,548	105,120.00	898,565,760
lcl	G	Energy	1 h	U	713	713	13,385.07	9,543,553
london_smart_meters_with_missing	G	Energy	30 min	U	5,520	5,520	30,115.74	166,238,880
m1_monthly	G	Econ./finance	1 mo	U	617	617	72.76	44,892
m5	G	Sales/retail	1 d	U	30,490	30,490	1,913.00	58,327,370
monash_m3_monthly	G	Econ./finance	1 mo	U	1,428	1,428	99.34	141,858
monash_m3_other	G	Econ./finance	1 qtr	U	174	174	68.58	11,933
monash_m3_quarterly	G	Econ./finance	1 qtr	U	756	756	48.95	37,004
nn5_daily_with_missing	G	Econ./finance	1 d	U	111	111	735.00	81,585
nn5_weekly	G	Econ./finance	1 wk	U	111	111	105.00	11,655
oikolab_weather	G	Climate	1 h	U	8	8	100,057.00	800,456
pedestrian_counts	G	Transport	1 h	U	66	66	47,435.79	3,130,762
rideshare_with_missing	G	Transport	1 h	U	2,304	2,304	373.00	859,392
subseasonal_precip	G	Climate	1 d	U	862	862	11,323.00	9,760,426
taxi_30min	G	Transport	30 min	U	67,984	67,984	809.00	54,999,056
tourism_monthly	G	Tourism	1 mo	U	366	366	274.58	100,496
tourism_quarterly	G	Tourism	1 qtr	U	427	427	91.63	39,128
traffic_hourly	G	Transport	1 h	U	862	862	17,376.00	14,978,112
traffic_weekly	G	Transport	1 wk	U	862	862	96.00	82,752
uber_tlc_daily	G	Transport	1 d	U	262	262	179.72	47,087
uber_tlc_hourly	G	Transport	1 h	U	262	262	4,310.85	1,129,444
vehicle_trips_with_missing	G	Transport	1 d	U	329	329	98.82	32,512
weather	G	Climate	1 d	U	3,010	3,010	14,266.35	42,941,700
wiki-rolling_nips	G	Web	1 d	U	47,675	47,675	852.00	40,619,100

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Table 15 – continued from previous page

Dataset	Src.	Domain	Freq.	Type	Samples	Channels	Mean length	Observations
<code>wind_farms_with_missing</code>	G	Energy	1 min	U	337	337	510,876.47	172,165,370

C Configuration of Tabby-Small

To reduce the computational cost of controlled ablation studies, we construct TABBY-SMALL by reducing the depth and hidden dimension of the full model while retaining its long-context input representation, patch-based encoder, probabilistic quantile decoder, masking objective, and pretraining data mixture. The resulting model contains exactly 40,291,456 parameters (40.291M), measured directly from the checkpoint at step 110,000. The checkpoint contains 157 parameter tensors with a raw weight size of 153.700 MiB.

The model is trained for 110,000 optimization steps on eight GPUs. With a per-device batch size of 64 and no gradient accumulation, its global batch size is

$$B_{\text{global}} = 8 \times 64 \times 1 = 512.$$

The total number of sampled training windows is therefore

$$N_{\text{windows}} = 110,000 \times 512 = 56,320,000.$$

This value represents the number of sample exposures during optimization rather than the number of unique time series, because the stored corpora are repeatedly sampled and CauKerV2 generates synthetic samples online. The complete configuration is reported in Table 16.

Table 16: Complete architecture, data, masking, supervision, and optimization configuration of TABBY-SMALL.

Configuration	Value
<i>Model architecture</i>	
Context length	8,192
Patch size	16
Maximum number of patch tokens	512
Number of Transformer layers	12
Hidden dimension	512
Attention-head dimension	32
Number of attention heads	16
MLP expansion ratio	4
MLP hidden dimension	2,048
Dropout probability	0.10
Number of predicted quantiles	99
Number of parameter tensors	157
Number of parameters	40,291,456
Number of parameters in millions	40.291M
Raw checkpoint weight size	153.700 MiB
<i>Pretraining data mixture</i>	
BLAST sampling ratio	0.35
KernelSynth sampling ratio	0.30
GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ sampling ratio	0.25
CauKerV2 sampling ratio	0.10
Mixup sampling ratio	0
Minimum general real-series length	64
BLAST sequence-length range	[96, 4096]
KernelSynth sequence-length range	[96, 8192]
GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ sequence-length range	[2048, 8192]
CauKerV2 sequence-length range	[96, 2048]
Sequence-length sampling strategy	Uniform
Length-weighting coefficient	0.5
GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ balancing	Dataset/domain balanced

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Table 16 continued

Configuration	Value
KernelSynth shard balancing	Enabled
<i>CauKerV2 configuration</i>	
Generation mode	Online
Number of generated features	8
Number of SCM nodes	8
Maximum number of parents per node	2
Maximum generated sequence length	2,048
<i>Data-loading configuration</i>	
Number of BLAST workers	3
Number of KernelSynth workers	3
Number of GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ workers	3
Number of mixup workers	0
Prefetch factor	4
<i>Masking configuration</i>	
Overall mask ratio	0.40
Number of CPM blocks	8
Minimum terminal-mask length	0 patches
Maximum terminal-mask length	3 patches
<i>Deep-supervision configuration</i>	
Deep supervision	Enabled
Number of supervised exits	5
Decoded exit layers	{0, 3, 6, 9, 12}
Deep-supervision weight λ_{DS}	0.5
Trajectory-regularization weight λ_{TRA}	0.1
Depth-weighting exponent γ	1.0
<i>Optimization configuration</i>	
Total optimization steps	110,000
Number of GPUs	8
Per-device batch size	64
Gradient-accumulation steps	1
Global batch size	512
Total sampled training windows	56.32M
Training precision	bfloat16
Optimizer	AdamW
First-moment coefficient β_1	0.9
Second-moment coefficient β_2	0.95
Weight decay	0.1
Maximum gradient norm	1.0
<i>Learning-rate schedule</i>	
Scheduler	Multi-stage WSD
Number of stable-decay cycles	2
Warm-up steps	10,000
Decay steps	10,000
Peak learning rate	2×10^{-4}
Minimum learning rate	1×10^{-5}
<i>Checkpointing and logging</i>	
Checkpoint interval	5,000 steps
Final analyzed checkpoint	Step 110,000
Logging interval	100 steps
Training log format	JSON Lines

All controlled comparisons in the analysis use this configuration as their reference setting. For each ablation, only the component under investigation is modified; the model size, pretraining data mixture, global batch size, optimization horizon, and all remaining hyperparameters are held fixed.

D Synthetic Data Generation and Hyperparameters

Scope. The synthetic component of the final training sampler consists of two distinct streams: pre-generated KernelSynth series and CauKerV2 series generated online. Their sampling probabilities are 0.30 and 0.10, respectively; the remaining 0.60 is assigned to the two real-world streams. These probabilities specify how training examples are drawn and should not be interpreted as the relative sizes of stored datasets. KernelSynth is finite and stored in Arrow files, whereas CauKerV2 is an infinite iterable stream whose samples are generated independently by each data-loader worker.

The values below are taken directly from the supplied implementation. We distinguish fixed generator distributions from constructor defaults. The latter can be overridden by the training command and therefore do not, by themselves, establish the values used by the final checkpoint.

D.1 KernelSynth

Coarse-grid generation. For a requested target length T , our KernelSynth construction generates a Gaussian-process realization on a grid that is four times coarser and then upsamples it to the target grid. Let $r = 4$ and $T_c \simeq T/r$. The stored sequence is

$$\tilde{\mathbf{x}}_{1:T} = \mathcal{I}_r(\mathbf{x}_{1:T_c}^{\text{GP}}),$$

where $\mathcal{I}_r$ denotes the interpolation operator. Reducing the covariance grid from T to approximately $T/4$ lowers a quadratic covariance-construction term by

$$\frac{T_c^2}{T^2} \simeq \frac{1}{16}.$$

Independent output shards are generated by separate CPU tasks and stored in the GluonTS Arrow format. The supplied file contains the Arrow reader but not the offline KernelSynth producer. Consequently, the exact interpolation operator, the producer-side kernel-sampling distributions, and the number of generated shards cannot be recovered from this file and are not specified here.

Arrow sampling. At training time, all `.arrow` files are discovered recursively. With file balancing enabled, a worker shuffles the complete file list and draws one valid record from each file before reshuffling. Within a file, records are selected uniformly by random access when available. A failed or malformed record is rejected, with at most 32 attempts for the selected file. The extracted sequence is passed to the same formatting routine used for real data, which performs subwindow sampling and left padding to the model context.

Table 17: KernelSynth reader defaults. These are implementation defaults; final launch-time overrides are not shown.

Parameter	Default	Meaning
<code>context_length</code>	2,048×4	Padded model input length
<code>min_sample_length</code>	96	Minimum sampled training length
<code>max_sample_length</code>	8,192	Maximum sampled training length

D.2 CauKerV2

Online generation pipeline. For each multivariate draw, CauKerV2 first samples a sequence length L and constructs K primitive root series,

$$\mathbf{U} = [\mathbf{u}_1, \dots, \mathbf{u}_K] \in \mathbb{R}^{L \times K}.$$

The primitive family assigned to each column is selected by a weighted schedule. A random directed acyclic graph then transforms these roots into P observed series,

$$\mathbf{X} = [\mathbf{x}_1, \dots, \mathbf{x}_P] \in \mathbb{R}^{L \times P}.$$

The current pretraining objective is channel independent. The P output channels are therefore shuffled in a local buffer and yielded separately as P univariate training examples. Each sequence is placed at the end of a zero-initialized context window, with left padding marked by the padding mask.

Length sampling. The default length sampler is log-uniform. For lower and upper bounds $L_{\min}$ and $L_{\max}$,

$$\log L \sim \mathcal{U}(\log L_{\min}, \log L_{\max}), \quad L = \text{clip}(\text{round}(e^{\log L}), L_{\min}, L_{\max}).$$

Uniform integer sampling is also implemented as an alternative. Invalid numerical draws are rejected and regenerated without terminating the iterable stream.

Table 18: Constructor defaults of `OnlineCauKerIterableDataset`. Values passed by the final launch command override this table.

Parameter	Default	Meaning
<code>context_length</code>	2,048	Padded model input length
<code>L_{min}: min_length</code>	96	Minimum generated length
<code>L_{max}: max_length</code>	2,048	Maximum generated length
<code>P: num_features</code>	8	Observed SCM channels
<code>K: num_nodes</code>	8	Primitive root series (latent dimension)
<code>M: max_parents</code>	6	Maximum parents of an observed node
<code>length_sampling</code>	log-uniform	Distribution over L
Normalization clip	8	Robust-normalization clipping threshold
Numerical ϵ	10^{-6}	Minimum admissible standard deviation

D.2.1 Primitive generator portfolio

The default portfolio contains ten generator families. Let w_f be the weight assigned to family f . For a draw with K roots, the implementation first allocates $\lfloor Kw_f \rfloor$ roots, applies a minimum-one heuristic when $K \geq 10$, corrects any resulting over-allocation, distributes the remaining roots according to the largest fractional remainders, and finally shuffles the schedule. The over-allocation correction may remove a previously assigned minimum-one slot. Under the default weights in Table 19, all ten families are simultaneously represented only from $K = 12$ onward; $K = 10$ or 11 can still omit low-weight families. The constructor default $K = 8$ therefore does not provide full per-draw coverage.

Table 19: Default primitive-family weights used by `CauKerV2`. The weights sum to one.

Generator family	Weight
Compositional-kernel Gaussian process	0.10
Trend–seasonality decomposition	0.10
Regime-switching Ornstein–Uhlenbeck SDE	0.10
ARIMA/SARIMA state-space process	0.10
Piecewise level and change-point process	0.10
Spike and event process	0.30
Analytic waveform mixture	0.05
Fractional Brownian motion/noise	0.05
GARCH-family volatility process	0.05
Chaotic and audio-inspired process	0.05

Table 20: Code-level hyperparameter distributions for the ten CauKerV2 primitive generators. $\mathcal{U}(a, b)$ denotes a continuous uniform distribution and $\text{LogU}(a, b)$ a log-uniform distribution.

Family	Implemented distributions and choices
Compositional-kernel GP	Select $m \sim \text{UnifInt}\{1, \dots, 7\}$ kernels with replacement from a 33-entry bank. Periodic kernels use normalized periods $\{24, 48, 96, 168, 336, 672, 7, 14, 30, 60, 365, 730, 4, 26, 52, 4, 6, 12, 4, 40, 10\}/L$; dot-product kernels use $\sigma_0 \in \{0, 1, 10\}$; RBF length scales are $\{0.1, 1, 10\}$; rational-quadratic α values are $\{0.1, 1, 10\}$; white-noise levels are $\{0.1, 1\}$; and one constant kernel is included. Successive kernels are combined by addition or multiplication with probability 0.5 each. Two mean functions are sampled with replacement from zero, linear, exponential, and sparse-anomaly means and are also added or multiplied with probability 0.5. Linear slopes/intercepts follow $\mathcal{U}(-1, 1)$; exponential amplitude/rate follow $\mathcal{U}(0.5, 1.5)$; the anomaly mean contains 1–5 impulses with amplitudes $\mathcal{U}(-5, 5)$. GP covariance jitter is 10^{-6} .
Trend–seasonality	Trend type probabilities for none, linear, quadratic, exponential, damped, and piecewise trends are $(0.08, 0.27, 0.20, 0.15, 0.15, 0.15)$. Linear slopes are $\mathcal{U}(-3, 3)$; quadratic coefficients use $\mathcal{U}(-4, 4)$ and $\mathcal{U}(-2, 2)$; exponential rate is $\mathcal{U}(-3, 3)$ with amplitude $\mathcal{U}(0.3, 2)$; damped rate is $\mathcal{U}(1, 8)$. The number of seasonal components is uniform in $\{0, 1, 2, 3\}$, with candidate periods $\{4, 6, 7, 12, 24, 48, 52, 96, 168, 336\}$, amplitude $\mathcal{U}(0.2, 2)$, and phase $\mathcal{U}(0, 2\pi)$. Seasonal waveform probabilities for sine, triangle, step, and impulse are $(0.55, 0.20, 0.15, 0.10)$. Irregular-component probabilities for white, colored, random-walk, and fBm-like noise are $(0.35, 0.35, 0.15, 0.15)$. Additive, multiplicative, and mixed composition probabilities are $(0.55, 0.20, 0.25)$.
ARIMA/SARIMA	Burn-in is 300. AR and MA orders are sampled from $\{0, 1, 2, 3\}$ with probabilities $(0.1, 0.3, 0.4, 0.2)$; if both are zero, p is reset to one. Differencing order $d \in \{0, 1, 2\}$ has probabilities $(0.50, 0.40, 0.10)$. AR and MA coefficients follow $\mathcal{U}(-0.8, 0.8)$ and are rescaled when their ℓ_1 norm exceeds 0.92. Innovation scale follows $\text{LogU}(0.02, 1)$. A seasonal AR term is added with probability 0.35, with lag in $\{4, 7, 12, 24, 52, 96\}$ and coefficient $\mathcal{U}(-0.5, 0.5)$.
Regime-switching OU SDE	The number of regimes is 2, 3, or 4 with probabilities $(0.50, 0.30, 0.20)$. The base mean follows $\mathcal{U}(-2, 2)$; signed regime offsets have magnitudes $\mathcal{U}(0.5, 4)$; mean-reversion rates follow $\mathcal{U}(0.03, 3)$; and diffusion scales follow $\mathcal{U}(0.03, 1.5)$. Transition rows are Dirichlet distributed with diagonal concentration $\mathcal{U}(10, 50)$. A sinusoidal perturbation of the regime mean is enabled with probability 0.4, with amplitude $\mathcal{U}(0, 0.8)$ and period $\mathcal{U}(24, \max(25, L/2))$.
Piecewise level/change point	The segment count is a clipped geometric draw, $\min\{\max(2, G + 1), \max(3, \lfloor L/8 \rfloor)\}$ with $G \sim \text{Geometric}(0.15)$. Segment proportions are Dirichlet with concentration $\mathcal{U}(0.5, 2)$. Level modes uniform, random walk, and clustered have probabilities $(0.35, 0.40, 0.25)$. Transition modes hard, ramp, and sigmoid have probabilities $(0.50, 0.30, 0.20)$; smooth-transition width is $\mathcal{U}(0.01L, 0.05L)$. White noise is added with probability 0.70 and scale $\mathcal{U}(0.02, 0.30)$; an additional trend–seasonality component, scaled by 0.3, is added with probability 0.35.
Spike/event	Baseline probabilities for kernel GP, trend–seasonality, flat noise, and OU are $(0.25, 0.45, 0.15, 0.15)$. The event count is a clipped Poisson draw with rate $\max(1, L/160)$. Event-mode probabilities for point, Gaussian, plateau, shock–recovery, and periodic events are $(0.25, 0.30, 0.20, 0.15, 0.10)$. Signed event amplitudes have magnitude $\text{LogU}(0.8, 6)$. Periodic-event spacing is sampled between 16 and approximately $L/4$; plateau width is sampled between 2 and approximately $L/20$; shock–recovery width is sampled between 4 and approximately $L/12$. Final noise scale follows $\mathcal{U}(0.01, 0.25)$.
Analytic waveform	The number of component waves is uniform in $\{1, 2, 3\}$. Sawtooth, square, and triangle shapes are sampled uniformly; amplitude follows $\mathcal{U}(0.3, 3)$, frequency $\mathcal{U}(1, 50)$ cycles per normalized interval, and phase $\mathcal{U}(0, 1)$ cycles. Square-wave duty cycle follows $\mathcal{U}(0.2, 0.8)$. Amplitude modulation is enabled independently for each component with probability 0.30, with modulation frequency $\mathcal{U}(0.5, 5)$ and depth $\mathcal{U}(0.1, 0.8)$. A linear trend is added with probability 0.30, and Gaussian noise with scale $\mathcal{U}(0.01, 0.30)$ is added with probability 0.70.
Fractional Brownian motion/noise	The Hurst parameter follows $\mathcal{U}(0.1, 0.9)$ and fGn versus fBm is selected uniformly. The spectral exponent is $\beta = \text{clip}(2H - 1, -0.8, 0.8)$. fBm is approximated by cumulatively summing colored-noise increments. The final amplitude follows $\text{LogU}(0.1, 5)$.
GARCH-family volatility	GARCH, GJR-GARCH, and EGARCH are selected uniformly; normal and Student- t innovations are selected uniformly. Student- t degrees of freedom follow $\mathcal{U}(3, 10)$. Zero, constant, and AR(1) means have probabilities $(0.55, 0.20, 0.25)$; the AR coefficient follows $\mathcal{U}(-0.3, 0.3)$. Unconditional volatility follows $\text{LogU}(0.005, 0.5)$ and burn-in is 500. GARCH/GJR persistence follows $\mathcal{U}(0.70, 0.97)$; EGARCH uses $\beta \sim \mathcal{U}(0.70, 0.97)$, $\alpha \sim \mathcal{U}(0.05, 0.25)$, and $\gamma \sim \mathcal{U}(-0.20, 0.20)$. Returns are cumulatively summed with probability 0.5.
Chaotic/audio-inspired	Lorenz, Mackey–Glass, NARMA, and audio-like subtypes are selected with probability 0.25 each. Lorenz uses burn-in 800, step size $\mathcal{U}(0.005, 0.02)$, $\sigma \sim \mathcal{U}(8, 12)$, $\rho \sim \mathcal{U}(24, 30)$, and $\beta \sim \mathcal{U}(2, 3.5)$. Mackey–Glass uses burn-in 1,000, delay 15–30, exponent 8–12, coefficient ranges $\mathcal{U}(0.15, 0.25)$ and $\mathcal{U}(0.05, 0.15)$, and step size $\mathcal{U}(0.5, 2)$. NARMA order is 5–14. Audio-like signals contain 2–5 oscillatory layers with frequency $\text{LogU}(1, 80)$ and amplitude $\text{LogU}(0.1, 1.5)$, optional rhythmic events with probability 0.7, and colored noise with $\beta \sim \mathcal{U}(0.5, 2)$.

D.2.2 Random structural causal model

The online SCM contains K root nodes and P observed non-root nodes. Every primitive series is assigned bijectively to one root, and every root is forced to influence at least one observed node. Observed nodes may additionally depend on earlier observed nodes, so the graph can be deeper than two computational layers while remaining acyclic. The implementation requires

$$K \leq PM,$$

where M is the maximum number of parents. For a root node j and a non-root node j , respectively,

$$x_j(t) = a_j u_{s_j}(t) + \epsilon_j(t), \quad x_j(t) = \phi_j \left(\sum_{p \in \text{Pa}(j)} w_{jp} x_p(t) \right) + \epsilon_j(t).$$

Anchor roots are first distributed across observed nodes. The remaining parent slots are sampled without replacement from all earlier nodes in the random topological order. Conditional on the admissible range, the parent count is sampled uniformly. Edge weights are independent standard normal draws.

Table 21: Fixed hyperparameter distributions of the online CauKerV2 SCM.

Component	Distribution or value
Root scale a_j	LogU(0.6, 1.8)
Node noise scale	LogU(0.01, 0.15)
Edge weight w_{jp}	$\mathcal{N}(0, 1)$
Activation family	Uniform over linear, ReLU, sigmoid, sine, modulo, leaky-ReLU
Linear slope	$\mathcal{U}(0.5, 2)$; intercept fixed to zero
Modulo constant	$\mathcal{U}(1, 5)$
Leaky-ReLU slope	$\mathcal{U}(0.01, 0.3)$
Sigmoid numerical clip	Input clipped to $[-40, 40]$
Post-SCM normalization	Independently applied to every observed channel

Robust normalization. Primitive roots and final observed channels are normalized independently. Non-finite values are first replaced by zero. For a sequence $\mathbf{z}$, the transformation subtracts the median, divides by a safe standard deviation, clips the result to $[-8, 8]$, subtracts the post-clipping mean, and divides by the standard deviation again. Standard deviations below 10^{-6} are replaced by one. Before padding, the float32 output is additionally clipped to $[-10^6, 10^6]$.

Implemented but separate Arrow-rooted mode. The code also defines an `ArrowCauKerSCMIterableDataset`, in which Arrow records serve as SCM root nodes. This is a separate experimental path: the reported data pipeline uses direct Arrow sampling for `KernelSynth` and `OnlineCauKerIterableDataset` for CauKerV2. We therefore do not include Arrow-rooted SCM defaults in the reported corpus configuration.

Launch-time values requiring the final run manifest. The supplied implementation does not contain the resolved training command. Consequently, the final stage-specific values of $L_{\min}$, $L_{\max}$, K , P , M , the base seed, and any generator-weight JSON override cannot be verified from this file. The final release should record these values together with the `KernelSynth` producer command, interpolation operator, Arrow shard count, and the exact accounting used for the reported synthetic-corpus size.

Table 22: Layer-wise functional ablation on GIFT-Eval with and without DQS. Values are percentage changes relative to each checkpoint’s intact baseline; positive values indicate degradation. Each row bypasses one block without fine-tuning. Both training variants cover 97 configurations.

Skipped layer	$\Delta\text{MASE (\%)}$		$\Delta\text{CRPS (\%)}$	
	w/ DQS	w/o DQS	w/ DQS	w/o DQS
0	+25.31	+20.94	+24.02	+20.14
1	+7.67	+9.93	+7.54	+9.02
2	+5.86	+4.41	+4.82	+4.57
3	+1.82	+1.69	+2.20	+1.49
4	+1.31	+1.34	+1.54	+1.47
5	+2.50	+2.49	+2.10	+1.69
6	+1.13	+0.11	+0.91	-0.05
7	+1.52	+0.09	+1.07	-0.14
8	+1.63	+0.93	+1.45	+0.92
9	+1.39	+1.64	+1.57	+1.59
10	+1.52	+1.66	+1.42	+1.00
11	+3.08	+2.69	+2.94	+2.10

E Additional Analysis of Deep Quantile Supervision

E.1 Layer-Wise Functional Ablation

We compare the layer-wise sensitivity of checkpoints trained with and without DQS. This experiment uses the smaller model trained for the ablation study, with

$$M = 12, \quad d_{\text{model}} = 512, \quad d_{\text{head}} = 32, \quad P = 16, \quad T = 8192,$$

an MLP expansion ratio of 4, dropout of 0.1, and 99 output quantiles. For each zero-indexed layer $\ell \in \{0, \dots, 11\}$, we bypass only that Transformer block during inference by replacing its transformation with the identity mapping,

$$h_{\ell+1} = h_{\ell}.$$

All other blocks and parameters remain unchanged, and no fine-tuning is performed after the intervention. This measures the sensitivity of the trained predictor to removing one block at a time.

For each checkpoint, we compare every ablation with its corresponding intact model on a fixed set of GIFT-Eval configurations. Both training variants have results for 97 configurations. In the completed without-DQS evaluation, the intact model and all twelve ablations cover exactly the same configurations. We report relative changes within each checkpoint. CRPS is represented by the mean weighted quantile loss reported by the evaluator.

Let $q \in \{\text{DQS}, \text{noDQS}\}$ denote the training variant, $\mathcal{D}_q$ its evaluation set, and $N_q = |\mathcal{D}_q| = 97$. For metric m , define the relative change caused by bypassing layer ℓ as

$$\Delta_{\ell,q}^m = 100 \left\{ \exp \left[\frac{1}{N_q} \sum_{d \in \mathcal{D}_q} \log \left(\frac{m_{q,\ell,d}}{m_{q,\text{full},d}} \right) \right] - 1 \right\}.$$

Here, $m_{q,\text{full},d}$ is the error of the intact checkpoint and $m_{q,\ell,d}$ is the error after bypassing layer ℓ . Positive values indicate degradation, and negative values indicate improvement. On a fixed evaluation set, this expression also equals the relative change in the Seasonal-Naive-normalized geometric mean, because the normalization factors cancel between the ablated and intact models.

Table 22 shows that the first block has the largest ablation effect in both checkpoints. Bypassing it increases MASE and CRPS by 25.31% and 24.02% with DQS, compared with 20.94% and 20.14% without DQS. In the DQS checkpoint, bypassing any individual block increases both aggregate metrics, with minimum increases of 1.13% in MASE and 0.91% in CRPS.

The clearest qualitative difference occurs at layers 6 and 7. Without DQS, bypassing these layers changes MASE by only +0.11% and +0.09%, while CRPS improves slightly by 0.05% and 0.14%. With DQS, the corresponding MASE increases are 1.13% and 1.52%, and the CRPS increases are 0.91% and 1.07%. These observations are consistent with DQS reducing local functional redundancy at intermediate depth. The effect is layer dependent: for example, bypassing layer 1 causes greater degradation in the without-DQS checkpoint.

Low aggregate sensitivity does not imply that a block is irrelevant to every task. Without DQS, bypassing layer 6 reduces MASE by 17.11% on `solar/10T/long`, but increases it by 13.79% on `jena_weather/D/short`. Thus, the near-zero aggregate change also reflects offsetting improvements and degradations across tasks. The results therefore support the interpretation that DQS encourages useful transformations at intermediate depth. This evidence concerns the tested checkpoints and single-block interventions; it does not establish parameter inactivity or the effect of jointly removing multiple blocks.

F Zero-Shot Anomaly Detection: Details

Setup We evaluate on TSB-AD-U (Liu & Paparrizos, 2024) using the benchmark’s unsupervised protocol: each detector receives the full series and no training data. The per-series sliding window for VUS-PR is set by the benchmark’s own `find_length_rank` convention (rank 1). We report mean VUS-PR over the 350 series of the evaluation split; the latent distance metric was selected on the disjoint 48-series tuning split, and no selection of any kind was performed on the evaluation split.

Scoring Each series is tiled into non-overlapping windows of the model’s context length W , with the final window right-aligned to cover the tail. Series shorter than W form a single left-padded window; series shorter than one patch fall back to a z-score. Each window is normalised over its visible points as $\tilde{x} = \text{asinh}((x - \mu_w)/\sigma_w)$, making the score invariant to per-window level and scale. Windows are encoded by the frozen backbone and we take the output of the final Transformer block; the quantile head is discarded. Padding patches are dropped and the remaining content patches are pooled across all windows into $\mathbf{P} \in \mathbb{R}^{n_p \times d}$, with $n_p \approx T/L$ for patch size L . We fit $\boldsymbol{\mu} = \text{mean}(\mathbf{P})$ and the sample covariance $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}$, apply shrinkage $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_\lambda = (1 - \lambda)\boldsymbol{\Sigma} + \lambda \frac{\text{tr}(\boldsymbol{\Sigma})}{d}\mathbf{I}$ with $\lambda = 0.1$, and score each patch by $a_i = \sqrt{\max((\mathbf{p}_i - \boldsymbol{\mu})^\top \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_\lambda^{-1} (\mathbf{p}_i - \boldsymbol{\mu}), 0)}$ using the pseudo-inverse. Patch scores are broadcast to the L timesteps they cover, averaged where windows overlap, and min-max scaled to $[0, 1]$.

Metric selection and results Table 23 compares latent distance metrics on the tuning split. Full-covariance Mahalanobis is best on both mean and median, and its margin over the diagonal variant indicates that off-diagonal structure in the embedding distribution carries usable signal. The selected metric transfers without degradation: 0.4379 mean VUS-PR on tuning against 0.4282 on evaluation, with the median improving from 0.3716 to 0.4024 on the larger split. Table 24 reports the full set of evaluation-split measures, with all 350 series scored successfully. Scoring requires $\lceil T/W \rceil$ forward passes per series.

Table 23: Latent distance metrics on the TSB-AD-U tuning split (48 series).

Metric	Mean	Median
Mahalanobis (full)	0.4379	0.3716
Centroid (robust)	0.4077	0.3190
Mahalanobis (diagonal)	0.4075	0.3366
Centroid	0.3713	0.2669

Table 24: TABBY on the TSB-AD-U evaluation split (350 series).

Measure	Mean	Median
VUS-PR	0.4282	0.4024
AUC-PR	0.3408	0.2643
VUS-ROC	0.8364	0.9334

G Optimizer-Aware Analysis of the DQS Update Direction

G.1 Question and Gradient Construction

Let θ_0 denote the parameters of the 110K TABBY-SMALL checkpoint. Let $\mathcal{L}_T$ be the final-exit quantile pinball loss and $\mathcal{L}_D$ the unscaled DQS loss. For a 12-block backbone, the latter is

$$\mathcal{L}_D = \sum_{k \in \{3, 6, 9, 12\}: k < 12} \left(\frac{k}{12}\right)^\gamma \mathcal{L}_{\text{pinball}}^{(k)}, \quad \gamma = 1. \quad (12)$$

The deepest exit is the final prediction objective and is consequently not counted again as auxiliary supervision. On one shared update batch, we compute

$$g_T = \nabla_{\theta} \mathcal{L}_T(\theta_0), \quad g_D = \nabla_{\theta} \mathcal{L}_D(\theta_0). \quad (13)$$

We then construct

$$g_A = g_T, \quad (14)$$

$$g_B = g_T + \lambda_{\text{DS}} g_D, \quad \lambda_{\text{DS}} = 0.5, \quad (15)$$

$$g_M = c g_T, \quad c = \frac{\|g_B\|_2}{\|g_T\|_2}. \quad (16)$$

Thus, g_M and g_B have the same Euclidean norm, while g_M retains the direction of g_T . Comparing B with A alone would not separate a directional effect from an increase in gradient magnitude; B versus M provides this control.

G.2 Optimizer-Aware Equal-Displacement Intervention

AdamW does not map a current gradient to a parameter displacement by a simple scalar multiplication because the stored first- and second-moment states affect every coordinate. We therefore retain the optimizer state (m_0, v_0) from the checkpoint and pass all three gradients through exactly the same optimizer transformation. Denoting the resulting parameter displacement by

$$u_s = \text{AdamWStep}(\theta_0, g_s; m_0, v_0) - \theta_0, \quad s \in \{A, M, B\}, \quad (17)$$

we construct the equal-radius displacement

$$\tilde{u}_s(\rho) = \rho \|u_A\|_2 \frac{u_s}{\|u_s\|_2}, \quad \rho \in \{0.25, 0.5, 1\}. \quad (18)$$

Consequently,

$$\|\tilde{u}_A(\rho)\|_2 = \|\tilde{u}_M(\rho)\|_2 = \|\tilde{u}_B(\rho)\|_2. \quad (19)$$

Weight decay is set to zero for all branches so that the intervention isolates task-gradient effects, while the checkpoint learning rate and AdamW moments are retained. The same clipping rule is used for every branch. Only one of the 92 trials triggers clipping for M and B; their clipping factors are equal in that trial. The maximum relative mismatch between the final displacement norms is 2.61×10^{-5} .

For each branch, we temporarily evaluate

$$R_s(\rho) = R_V(\theta_0 + \tilde{u}_s(\rho)), \quad (20)$$

where R_V is the final-exit pinball loss on a held-out validation batch. The model and optimizer are restored after every branch and every trial. Exact restoration is verified: the repeated baseline loss has zero numerical difference, the model parameters are restored exactly, and the optimizer state hash is unchanged.

We report

$$\Delta_{BA}(\rho) = R_A(\rho) - R_B(\rho), \quad (21)$$

$$\Delta_{BM}(\rho) = R_M(\rho) - R_B(\rho), \quad (22)$$

$$G_B(\rho) = R_0 - R_B(\rho), \quad (23)$$

where $R_0 = R_V(\theta_0)$. Positive Δ_{BA} and Δ_{BM} mean that B has lower validation loss than the corresponding control. Positive G_B means that B also improves upon making no update. The relative effects divide each paired difference by R_0 before aggregation.

The validation gradient

$$g_V = \nabla_{\theta} R_V(\theta_0) \quad (24)$$

is used only for diagnosis and never to construct A, M, or B. For a sufficiently small displacement,

$$R_V(\theta_0 + u) = R_V(\theta_0) + \langle g_V, u \rangle + o(\|u\|_2), \quad (25)$$

which motivates measuring alignment with the validation descent direction. The final conclusions nevertheless use the actually evaluated losses rather than only this first-order approximation.

G.3 Data and Evaluation Protocol

We use only the official training portion of GIFT-Eval; benchmark test targets are never used. Configurations without a sufficiently long observed training series are excluded. The retained set contains the following 23 configurations from 16 original dataset groups. Their retained configurations are summarized below; “base” denotes the repository’s unqualified configuration.

Dataset group	Configuration(s)	Dataset group	Configuration(s)
LOOP Seattle	5T, H	ETT1	15T, H
M-DENSE	H	ETT2	15T, H
Bitbrains Fast	5T	Jena Weather	base, 10T, H
Bitbrains RND	5T	KDD 2018	H
BizITObs App.	base	M4 Daily	base
BizITObs L2C	5T	SaugeenDay	D
BizITObs Service	base	Solar	10T, H
Electricity	15T, H	US Births	D

For each retained series, the official training history is split temporally at 70%. Update windows are sampled from the earlier region and validation windows from the later region, separated by a gap of 128 time steps. Each window has 1,024 input time steps and a 32-step terminal forecasting target. At most 32 series are retained per configuration, and at least 95% of each window must be observed. Normalization statistics are computed only from the visible context in the asinh-normalized loss space.

Each trial uses one update window from every configuration, giving an update batch size of 23. The validation configuration is rotated across trials, with four trials per configuration and 92 paired trials in total. The prediction head is frozen, but gradients still propagate through it into the shared backbone. The flow-matching loss is disabled, ensuring that B differs from A only through DQS.

G.4 Aggregation and Uncertainty

Multiple frequencies and repeated windows from the same original dataset are not treated as independent observations. For every metric, we first average the paired trial-level effects within each of the 16 original dataset groups and then take the unweighted macro-average across groups. We obtain 95% confidence intervals by resampling these original-dataset group means with replacement for 10,000 paired cluster-bootstrap replicates. The fraction of positive trials is reported descriptively only; the effective unit for the reported interval is the original dataset group, not the individual window. This analysis concerns one fixed checkpoint and optimizer history and does not represent variation across independent pretraining runs.

G.5 Complete Aggregate Results

Table 25 reports the corresponding effects in raw pinball loss units. B is better than both A and M at every radius. The B–M confidence interval remains above zero throughout.

Table 25: Raw one-step loss differences, in units of 10^{-6} . Positive values favor B. Parentheses give 95% paired original-dataset cluster-bootstrap confidence intervals.

ρ	Δ_{BA}	Δ_{BM}	G_B
0.25	4.04 [0.43, 8.07]	4.14 [0.72, 7.94]	14.74 [0.06, 33.49]
0.50	8.05 [1.07, 15.97]	8.25 [1.51, 15.72]	28.83 [−0.09, 65.58]
1.00	15.99 [1.74, 31.48]	16.37 [2.98, 30.96]	55.19 [−0.52, 124.86]

Table 26: Relative one-step advantages of B at the primary radius $\rho = 1$, in percent. Positive values favor B. Results are first averaged over trials and configurations belonging to the same original dataset.

Dataset group	B–A	B–M	Dataset group	B–A	B–M
LOOP Seattle	0.0136	0.0112	ETT1	0.0087	0.0085
M-DENSE	0.0365	0.0371	ETT2	−0.0210	−0.0200
Bitbrains Fast	−0.0190	−0.0125	Jena Weather	0.0138	0.0148
Bitbrains RND	0.0217	0.0188	KDD 2018	0.0023	0.0047
BizITObs Application	0.1843	0.1578	M4 Daily	−0.0237	−0.0246
BizITObs L2C	0.1056	0.0990	SaugeenDay	0.0421	0.0431
BizITObs Service	0.0282	0.0275	Solar	0.0489	0.0383
Electricity	−0.0149	−0.0145	US Births	0.0046	0.0070

The point estimate $G_B > 0$ suggests that B can also be an absolute descent step for the held-out objective. However, its interval narrowly includes zero at the pre-specified primary radius $\rho = 1$, and the relative-gain interval also includes zero. We therefore use Δ_{BM} , not G_B , as the evidence for the stated directional claim.

The three radii probe the same directions and must not be counted as three independent replications. Nevertheless, they provide a useful locality check: all 16 dataset groups retain the same B–M sign across radii, the median ratio between the effects at $\rho = 1$ and $\rho = 0.25$ is 3.98, and the correlation between the first-order prediction and the measured B–M effect is 0.997 at $\rho = 1$.

G.6 Results by Original Dataset Group

The B–M group mean is positive for 12 of 16 groups. The macro-average is not determined by one favorable dataset: leave-one-group-out analysis keeps the B–M effect positive in every case, with a minimum remaining relative effect of 0.0159%. The median group effect is 0.0130%, compared with the mean of 0.0248%, indicating heterogeneous but not purely outlier-driven gains.

G.7 Directional and Layerwise Diagnostics

The average gradient-norm ratio is

$$\frac{\|g_B\|_2}{\|g_T\|_2} = 1.432, \quad (26)$$

while

$$\cos(g_T, g_D) = 0.717. \quad (27)$$

The latter corresponds to an angle of approximately 44° , confirming that DQS is not merely a positive scalar multiple of the final-loss gradient. The AdamW proposal cosines are 0.9946 between A and M and 0.9616 between A and B, corresponding to average angles of approximately 5.8° and 15.9° , respectively. Thus, gradient scaling interacts slightly with the stored optimizer state, which motivates retaining M, but DQS produces a substantially larger directional change.

For layer j , we additionally compute

$$A_j = \cos(g_{B,j}, g_{V,j}) - \cos(g_{T,j}, g_{V,j}). \quad (28)$$

Table 27 reports this exploratory diagnostic.

Table 27: Layerwise change in gradient alignment, A_j . Parentheses give 95% original-dataset cluster-bootstrap intervals. These correlated layerwise analyses are exploratory and are not corrected for multiple comparisons.

Parameter group	Alignment change	Parameter group	Alignment change
Position embedding	0.00039 [−0.00096, 0.00169]	Block 7	0.00079 [−0.00060, 0.00226]
Block 1	0.00197 [−0.00015, 0.00423]	Block 8	0.00071 [−0.00060, 0.00204]
Block 2	0.00178 [−0.00144, 0.00519]	Block 9	0.00193 [−0.00022, 0.00415]
Block 3	0.00218 [−0.00036, 0.00455]	Block 10	0
Block 4	0.00208 [−0.00103, 0.00507]	Block 11	0
Block 5	0.00145 [−0.00190, 0.00448]	Block 12	0
Block 6	0.00045 [−0.00267, 0.00356]	Input projection	0.01051 [0.00115, 0.02077]

All 11 parameter groups reached by the auxiliary exits have a positive mean alignment change. The input projection is the only individual group whose uncorrected interval excludes zero. Blocks 10–12 receive no auxiliary DQS gradient by construction, so their alignment change is exactly zero. Because the prediction head is frozen, the observed effect must arise through changes to the shared backbone rather than direct adaptation of the readout head.

G.8 Scope of the Conclusion

The experiment establishes a local comparative statement:

At one fixed 110K checkpoint and optimizer state, and for the sampled GIFT-Eval training-data mixture, DQS produces an optimizer-aware parameter update that is more favorable to the held-out final forecasting objective than both the final-only update and a raw-gradient-norm-matched control.

It does not establish that every DQS step is an absolute validation descent step, that the same effect holds at every stage of pretraining, or that the end-to-end DQS gain is caused exclusively by this mechanism. Establishing those stronger claims would require replication across checkpoints and pretraining seeds, together with controlled multi-step continuation runs.

H Restart-Peak Sensitivity of Stage-End Checkpoints

H.1 Objective

The progressive convergence learning rate schedule reduces the stable learning rate after every completed stable-decay stage. This design is motivated by the hypothesis that a peak learning rate that is appropriate early in pretraining may become excessively disruptive after the model has entered a better-converged region. We therefore examine two related questions:

1. Does the empirically optimal restart peak decrease as pretraining progresses?
2. Does the validation penalty induced by a fixed aggressive restart increase at later checkpoints?

The first question concerns the location of the optimum, whereas the second concerns the steepness of the learning-rate response curve. These questions must be distinguished because the optimum can remain at the boundary of the search grid even when sensitivity to larger learning rates changes substantially.

H.2 Models and Starting Checkpoints

We conduct the experiment on both TABBY-SMALL and the full TABBY model. The model architecture is recovered directly from each checkpoint, and all comparisons are performed only between checkpoints of the same model. Absolute validation losses are not compared across model sizes.

Table 28: Models and checkpoint branches used in the restart-peak experiment. The continuation batch size is the effective batch size used by the single-GPU probe, rather than the global batch size of the original distributed pretraining run.

Configuration	TABBY-SMALL	TABBY
Parameters	40.291M	145.843M
Transformer layers	12	20
Hidden dimension	512	768
Attention-head dimension	32	64
Context length	8,192	8,192
Patch size	16	16
Output quantiles	99	99
Starting checkpoints	55K, 110K	55K, 110K, 165K
Continuation batch size	80	150
GPUs per branch	1	1
Training seeds	1	1

All branches use seed 20260906. For each starting checkpoint, the model parameters, AdamW first- and second-moment estimates, and optimizer step are restored. The learning-rate scheduler is then replaced by the local restart-probe schedule described below. Model architecture, data mixture, masking configuration, weight decay, AdamW coefficients, gradient clipping, deep-supervision objectives, and all other available checkpoint settings are inherited without modification.

The historical checkpoints do not contain the exact per-rank random number generator and data-sampler states. Consequently, the experiment does not reproduce the unobserved data sequence that would have followed the original training run. Instead, all learning-rate branches from the same checkpoint are initialized with the same seed and sampling configuration, providing a controlled common future stream for comparing restart peaks.

H.3 Restart-Probe Schedule

For every model checkpoint and candidate peak learning rate, we run 1,500 additional optimizer steps. Let τ denote the local step following the restart, with $\tau = 0$ at the starting checkpoint. The learning-rate schedule is

$$\eta_\tau = \begin{cases} \eta_{\text{peak}}, & 0 \leq \tau < T_{\text{stable}}, \\ \eta_{\text{min}} + \frac{\eta_{\text{peak}} - \eta_{\text{min}}}{2} [1 + \cos(\pi u_\tau)], & T_{\text{stable}} \leq \tau < T_{\text{stable}} + T_{\text{cool}}, \end{cases} \quad (29)$$

where

$$u_\tau = \frac{\tau - T_{\text{stable}}}{T_{\text{cool}} - 1}, \quad T_{\text{stable}} = 1000, \quad T_{\text{cool}} = 500, \quad \eta_{\text{min}} = 10^{-5}. \quad (30)$$

The candidate grid is

$$\mathcal{G} = \{10^{-5}, 2.5 \times 10^{-5}, 5 \times 10^{-5}, 10^{-4}, 2 \times 10^{-4}\}. \quad (31)$$

No additional warm-up is applied: the learning rate is set directly to η_{peak} at the first continuation step. The $\eta_{\text{peak}} = 10^{-5}$ branch satisfies $\eta_{\text{peak}} = \eta_{\text{min}}$ and therefore serves as a no-restart control with a constant learning rate of 10^{-5} .

The complete experiment contains

$$2 \times 5 + 3 \times 5 = 25 \quad (32)$$

training branches, corresponding to 15,000 continuation steps for TABBY-SMALL and 22,500 continuation steps for the full model.

H.4 Fixed Validation Probe and Aggregation

Every final branch is evaluated on a fixed pretraining-distribution validation probe containing 256 series from each of the following four sources:

$$\mathcal{D} = \{\text{BLAST}, \text{KernelSynth}, \text{GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+}, \text{CauKerV2}\}. \quad (33)$$

The sampled series and prediction masks are generated once and reused for every model, checkpoint, and learning-rate branch. This probe does not use the downstream GIFT-Eval test set.

For validation series i , let $\mathcal{M}_i$ denote the evaluated masked timestamps and let $\mathcal{Q}$ be the set of 99 quantile levels. The per-series terminal pinball loss is

$$\ell_i = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{M}_i||\mathcal{Q}|} \sum_{t \in \mathcal{M}_i} \sum_{q \in \mathcal{Q}} \rho_q \left(x_{i,t} - \hat{x}_{i,t}^{(q)} \right), \quad (34)$$

where

$$\rho_q(u) = u(q - \mathbb{I}[u < 0]). \quad (35)$$

Let $s = (\text{model size}, \text{starting checkpoint})$ index one model-checkpoint pair. Let $n_i = |\mathcal{M}_i|$. Within source d , the losses are aggregated using square-root length weighting:

$$L_{s,d}(\eta) = \frac{\sum_{i \in d} n_i^{1/2} \ell_i}{\sum_{i \in d} n_i^{1/2}}. \quad (36)$$

The scalar score used to compare learning rates is the weighted geometric mean

$$G_s(\eta) = \exp \left[\sum_{d \in \mathcal{D}} w_d \log L_{s,d}(\eta) \right], \quad (37)$$

with

$$w_{\text{BLAST}} = w_{\text{KernelSynth}} = w_{\text{GIFT}} = 0.3, \quad w_{\text{CauKerV2}} = 0.1. \quad (38)$$

Lower values are better. We quantify restart sensitivity relative to the no-restart control as

$$P_s(\eta) = 100 \left[\frac{G_s(\eta)}{G_s(10^{-5})} - 1 \right]. \quad (39)$$

Thus, $P_s(\eta) > 0$ indicates that increasing the learning rate causes a higher terminal validation loss after the common cooldown.

Table 29: Complete restart-peak response. Entries are weighted geometric terminal validation losses $G_s(\eta)$; lower is better. Bold values indicate the best candidate for each checkpoint.

Model	Start	10^{-5}	2.5×10^{-5}	5×10^{-5}	10^{-4}	2×10^{-4}
Small	55K	0.096181	0.096301	0.096583	0.097285	0.098573
Small	110K	0.094641	0.094830	0.095235	0.096137	0.097691
Main	55K	0.090308	0.090411	0.090707	0.091437	0.092702
Main	110K	0.088560	0.088746	0.089096	0.089913	0.091745
Main	165K	0.087934	0.088084	0.088539	0.089310	0.091123

Table 30: Relative validation-loss increase $P_s(\eta)$ over the 10^{-5} continuation. Positive values indicate degradation.

Model	Start	2.5×10^{-5}	5×10^{-5}	10^{-4}	2×10^{-4}
Small	55K	+0.125%	+0.418%	+1.148%	+2.487%
Small	110K	+0.200%	+0.627%	+1.580%	+3.223%
Main	55K	+0.115%	+0.442%	+1.251%	+2.651%
Main	110K	+0.210%	+0.605%	+1.528%	+3.596%
Main	165K	+0.170%	+0.688%	+1.565%	+3.626%

H.5 Complete Learning-Rate Response

Table 29 reports the weighted geometric validation score for every branch. For every tested checkpoint, the score increases monotonically as the restart peak increases.

The corresponding relative penalties are reported in Table 30.

For TABBY-SMALL, the penalty produced by $\eta_{\text{peak}} = 2 \times 10^{-4}$ increases from 2.487% at 55K to 3.223% at 110K. For the full model, it increases from 2.651% at 55K to 3.596% at 110K and remains nearly unchanged at 3.626% at 165K. The effect therefore develops primarily between 55K and 110K and subsequently approaches a plateau.

H.6 Response-Curve Sensitivity

To summarize the complete response curve rather than a single aggressive peak, define

$$x(\eta) = \log_2 \frac{\eta}{10^{-5}}, \quad D_s(\eta) = \log G_s(\eta) - \log G_s(10^{-5}). \quad (40)$$

We fit the descriptive linear response

$$D_s(\eta) = a_s + S_s x(\eta) + \epsilon_{s,\eta} \quad (41)$$

over the five candidate learning rates. The coefficient S_s measures the increase in log validation loss per doubling of the restart peak.

Both models show an approximately 30% increase in response-curve sensitivity from 55K to 110K. For the full model, the additional increase from 110K to 165K is only 1.6%, again indicating that restart sensitivity largely saturates after 110K.

H.7 Source-Wise Sensitivity

Table 32 decomposes the penalty at the most aggressive tested restart, $\eta_{\text{peak}} = 2 \times 10^{-4}$, by validation source.

Table 31: Descriptive restart sensitivity measured over the complete learning-rate grid. Larger S_s indicates a steeper validation-loss response to increasing the restart peak.

Model	Start	S_s	Change from previous stage
Small	55K	0.005449	–
Small	110K	0.007098	+30.2%
Main	55K	0.005845	–
Main	110K	0.007694	+31.6%
Main	165K	0.007820	+1.6%

Table 32: Source-wise validation-loss increase under $\eta_{\text{peak}} = 2 \times 10^{-4}$ relative to the 10^{-5} continuation.

Model	Start	BLAST	CauKerV2	GIFT	KernelSynth
Small	55K	+0.922%	+1.885%	+0.959%	+5.859%
Small	110K	+1.302%	+2.234%	+0.973%	+7.870%
Main	55K	+0.882%	+1.220%	+1.980%	+5.632%
Main	110K	+1.548%	+1.925%	+2.766%	+7.117%
Main	165K	+1.690%	+1.492%	+3.360%	+6.608%

All four sources become more sensitive between 55K and 110K for the full model. Between 110K and 165K, the BLAST and GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ penalties continue to increase, whereas the CauKerV2 and KernelSynth penalties decrease moderately. Consequently, the aggregate sensitivity remains approximately constant over the final interval. KernelSynth contributes the largest individual component of the aggregate high-restart penalty, while the contribution from GIFT-Eval-Pretrain+ increases at later checkpoints.

H.8 Boundary Optima and Interpretation

For every checkpoint, the empirical optimum over $\mathcal{G}$ is the smallest candidate:

$$\hat{\eta}_{\text{Small},55K}^* = \hat{\eta}_{\text{Small},110K}^* = \hat{\eta}_{\text{Main},55K}^* = \hat{\eta}_{\text{Main},110K}^* = \hat{\eta}_{\text{Main},165K}^* = 10^{-5}. \quad (42)$$

A paired, source-stratified bootstrap with 10,000 resamples also places the optimum at 10^{-5} for every checkpoint. However, this produces a boundary solution rather than an interior estimate. The degenerate bootstrap intervals $[10^{-5}, 10^{-5}]$ should therefore not be interpreted as proving that the unconstrained optimal learning rates are exactly equal.

The experiment does not support the strict hypothesis that the location of the optimal restart peak decreases between adjacent checkpoints. It instead supports a different and complementary observation: the validation-loss response to a fixed high restart peak becomes substantially steeper from 55K to 110K and remains elevated at 165K. This distinction is important because the motivation for decreasing restart peaks does not require claiming that the global optimum has been identified by this short-horizon probe.

H.9 Limitations

The experiment evaluates a short continuation horizon rather than a complete stable-decay stage. A high restart peak may require more than 1,500 updates to recover from its initial perturbation, and the present results therefore characterize short-horizon restart sensitivity rather than the globally optimal peak for a full training stage.

Moreover, each branch is run with one training seed. The paired bootstrap measures uncertainty arising from the finite validation probe, but it does not account for variation across future training streams. Finally, the single-GPU continuation batches differ between TABBY-SMALL and the full model. The two models

are therefore used as independent replications of the stage-wise trend; their absolute sensitivity coefficients should not be directly compared.